

The Impact of Government Funding on Domestic Violence Shelters and Domestic Violence Incidents

Morgan Kearns*

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Abstract

Domestic violence (DV) shelters receive millions of dollars in government grants each year, yet little evidence documents how this funding shapes shelter operations or community-level violence. I build a novel panel of 47 Georgia DV shelters (2013–2023) using IRS Form 990 filings, linked to county-level violence and child-maltreatment records. This dataset provides the first systematic description of the Georgia DV shelter landscape: finances, staffing, and services offered. Using two-way fixed effects models with contemporaneous and lagged grant funding, I show that a \$100,000 increase in government grants raises shelter revenue by \$61,900 in the same year and by \$99,700 when the increase is reflected in both the current and prior year’s grant totals. Private donations show no corresponding decline. Total expenditure rises by \$57,300 in the same year and \$82,500 across both years. This increase is concentrated in compensation and program services. Employee counts rise as well. Estimated effects on community-level violence and child maltreatment, however, are small and imprecisely estimated.

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1 Introduction

Domestic violence (DV) is a prevalent public health concern. Almost half of women and four in ten men in the United States report experiencing DV in their lifetime (Leemis et al., 2022). DV shelters provide safe housing as well as services such as case management and counseling for victims leaving abusive situations, funded largely through the Victims of Crime Act (VOCA). This funding is substantial and volatile. Georgia alone received \$40.9 million in VOCA funds in 2025, while national VOCA distributions fell from \$1.9 billion in 2023 to \$1.3 billion in 2024 (Office for Victims of Crime, 2026). Yet little is known about how shelters use these funds or how funding affects shelter operations and DV outcomes.

This gap reflects a data constraint as no publicly available, longitudinal database of DV shelters exists or catalogs their funding and expenditures. I overcome this constraint by scraping IRS Form 990 filings to construct a novel panel of 47 Georgia DV shelters from 2013 to 2023, capturing shelter finances, operations, and grant funding. Linking this panel to Georgia’s state victim-services administrative records, I provide the first systematic description of the Georgia DV shelter landscape. This paper describes how many shelters operate, where they are located, and what services they provide. I then link shelter-level funding to county-level DV measures, enabling the first empirical analysis of how government funding shapes shelter operations and community-level violence.

I estimate two-way fixed effects models with contemporaneous and one-year lagged grant funding. DV shelters respond substantially to increases in government funding with increased revenue, expenditures, and staffing. A \$100,000 increase in government grants raises shelter revenue by \$61,900 in the same year and by \$99,700 when the increase is reflected in both the current and prior year’s grant totals. Private donations show no corresponding decline. Total expenditure rises by \$57,300 in the same year and \$82,500 across both years, concentrated in compensation and program services. I then examine whether this expanded capacity is reflected in county-level violence outcomes such as female homicide and assault rates. Estimated effects on community-level violence and child maltreatment are small and

imprecisely estimated, and none survive correction for multiple hypothesis testing. The financial response to funding is unambiguous. Effects on community-level violence and child maltreatment remain imprecisely estimated, and the data cannot distinguish a genuine null from an effect operating through unobserved channels such as service quality.

My results contribute to three literatures on nonprofit organizations and DV. First, I extend the literature on government funding and nonprofit organizations, which has shown that public grants can crowd out private donations, largely through reduced fundraising effort rather than donor substitution (Andreoni & Payne, 2011; Froelich, 1999; Pizzini & Sterin, 2023). I find no such crowd-out for DV shelters on average, though private donations decline significantly for small shelters specifically, suggesting the extent of crowd-out may depend on organizational scale. Funding stability also matters directly for these organizations. It affects staffing and retention, and prior work links it to program outcomes in other nonprofit sectors (Kim, 2017). I provide the first evidence on how government grants shape the finances and operations of DV shelters.

A large literature examines the effect of criminal justice interventions on domestic violence, including arrest policies, prosecution, restraining orders, and police presence, with mixed results (Aizer & Dal Bó, 2009; Black et al., 2023; Dugan et al., 2003; Raissian, 2016). These interventions primarily alter the abuser’s incentives through deterrence or legal consequence. A growing body of work also examines non-criminal levers: Sims et al. (2024) find no significant effect of state EITC expansions on lethal intimate partner violence, Carr and Packham (2021) show that SNAP disbursement timing affects DV incidence, and Geddes and Holz (2026) find that rent control reduces hospitalizations for female assault. These interventions ease the economic or housing constraints that shape household bargaining and exposure to violence. DV shelters operate outside the criminal justice system, expanding victims’ safety and exit options directly through refuge, safety planning, and advocacy. I contribute to both literatures by providing the first evidence on whether funding for these shelter programs affects violence and child maltreatment outcomes.

The most closely related work examines the effect of DV shelter access on homicides. Schechter (2023) finds that opening a shelter where none previously existed reduces female intimate-partner homicides by roughly one per 100,000 people every three to four years. Sims (2021) finds no causal effect of shelter-capacity changes on intimate partner violence (IPV) or DV homicides, with suggestive evidence that service quality matters more than bed count.¹ Both rely on variation at the extensive margin—openings, closings, and expansions—which are rare events. During the sample period, for example, there are no openings or closings in Georgia. I instead exploit variation in shelter funding and examine additional outcomes, including shelter operations, DV-related hospitalizations, and child maltreatment.

Section 2 describes the DV shelter sector and its federal funding. Section 3 details the panel dataset. Section 4 characterizes the Georgia DV shelter landscape and the services shelters provide. Section 5 presents the empirical strategy. Section 6 reports results, beginning with shelter finances and operations before turning to violence outcomes. Section 7 presents robustness checks, and Section 8 concludes.

2 Background

2.1 Domestic Violence Shelters

Domestic violence shelters provide immediate housing and structured programs for victims fleeing abusive relationships. Unlike homeless shelters, DV shelters give each resident a private room for the duration of their stay, and they are considerably smaller. Georgia’s DV shelters report approximately 1,000 beds,² compared to roughly 5,300 beds across the state’s homeless shelters (Department of Housing and Urban Development, 2024). Residents can access counseling, childcare, legal aid, and housing assistance (Craig, 2023), with Georgia shelters reporting as many as 40 distinct services (Criminal Justice Coordinating Council,

¹Sims (2021) is not publicly available; characterization is based on discussion with the author.

²Bed count was measured through reports and the author’s contact with shelters.

2017–2022). Staffing structure shapes the breadth of services offered. Shelters are typically organized around a program director and specialized advocates covering legal assistance, housing, and children’s services, and advocate caseloads determine which services victims can access.³ Bed capacity is a binding constraint. On a single day in September 2024, 1,393 individuals were in program-provided housing in Georgia while 275 housing requests went unmet (National Network to End Domestic Violence, 2024).

Victims who seek shelter services often have few alternatives for safe housing. Adams et al. (2008) found that 102 of 103 women receiving services from a DV organization had experienced economic abuse. Separately, Adams et al. (2012) show that IPV reduces job stability and economic well-being among low-income women for up to three years after the violence ends. Abusers further limit victims’ alternatives by isolating them from family and friends (DomesticShelters.org, 2015), and 73 percent of victims report remaining in abusive situations due to financial concerns (Adams et al., 2020). Between 22 and 57 percent of homeless women identify domestic violence as the immediate cause of their homelessness (Center for Impact Research, 2004; Institute for Children & Poverty, 2004; Wilder Research Center, 2004).

This paper examines how government funding affects shelter staffing and service delivery, and its effects on community-level violence and child maltreatment outcomes. Shelter finances and operations represent the organizational response through which funding reaches victims. Whether this organizational response translates into changes in community-level violence depends on three distinct channels.

First, additional funding may improve service quality for victims already in contact with shelters, through channels such as more intensive counseling, more consistent case management, or expanded legal advocacy. Funding operating through this channel could improve outcomes for shelter clients without producing any detectable change in community-level violence, since it affects victims already receiving help rather than the broader population of

³Based on staff pages from Georgia DV shelter websites and staffing constraint reports from the National Network to End Domestic Violence (National Network to End Domestic Violence, 2024).

victims in the county.

Second, additional funding may expand shelter capacity to serve victims who would not otherwise receive help, such as by funding additional caseworkers or beds. Extending services to more victims could reduce community-level violence, for example by helping additional victims leave abusive relationships or access protective resources. This channel is difficult to isolate empirically, since bringing more victims into contact with service providers such as shelters, hospitals, or the legal system can increase the number of cases recorded in administrative data, even when underlying violence declines. A rise in measured violence following a capacity expansion is therefore consistent with either an increase in underlying violence or increased reporting among victims newly connected to services.

Third, additional funding may expand outreach without expanding capacity. If funding increases outreach efforts such as hotline availability, advocacy, or public awareness, without a corresponding increase in beds or staff, victims may attempt to leave abusive relationships without access to adequate housing or safety resources. Leaving an abusive partner is one of the most dangerous periods for victims of intimate partner violence (Domestic Violence Coordinating Council, 2011), so outreach that increases departure attempts without expanding capacity could increase community-level violence.

These three channels imply different, and at times opposing, effects of shelter funding on community-level violence. A small or statistically insignificant estimated effect therefore does not indicate that organizational improvements failed to reach victims. I therefore interpret downstream violence estimates cautiously throughout the paper.

2.2 Victims of Crime Act Funding

Government funding is the largest resource for Georgia DV shelters, averaging 68 percent of shelter revenue (Kearns, 2026). The primary source is the Crime Victims Fund (CVF), established by the Victims of Crime Act of 1984 and financed by fines and penalties from federal criminal cases (Office for Victims of Crime, 2026). Congress caps the amount dis-

tributed to states each year. From the program’s introduction in 2000 through 2014, the cap ranged from \$500 million to \$700 million. Congress tripled the cap in 2015, and annual distributions ranged from \$2.4 to \$4.4 billion in the years since. After 2019, the CVF balance began to decline, partially eroding the post-2015 gains (Office for Victims of Crime, 2026).

States receive allocations proportional to population share. Georgia, with roughly 3 percent of the U.S. population, receives approximately 3 percent of total CVF funds distributed to states. Federal rules require states to direct at least 10 percent of CVF-funded Victim Assistance Grants to domestic violence programs, alongside equivalent 10 percent minimums for sexual assault and child abuse programs, for a combined 30 percent minimum across the three categories (34 U.S.C. §20103(a)(2)(B); Office for Victims of Crime, 2026). Georgia has allocated approximately 30 percent of its VOCA Victim Assistance Grant funds to domestic violence programs in practice. VOCA subgrantees are also required to use volunteers as a condition of funding, with waivers granted only where an organization demonstrates an inability to recruit or retain them (28 C.F.R. §94.113).

Within Georgia, the Criminal Justice Coordinating Council (CJCC) distributes federal funds to individual shelters, and its allocation criteria are not publicly documented. In a November 2025 interview, a director at the Georgia Coalition Against Domestic Violence (GCADV), which coordinates between CJCC and shelters on VOCA funding applications, reported that GCADV had helped CJCC develop a standardized allocation rubric. When I contacted CJCC directly to request a copy of the rubric, CJCC staff confirmed it had been developed but never implemented, and described no alternative systematic allocation process. Funding decisions therefore do not appear to follow a publicly documented formula, making future funding difficult for shelters to predict.

The 2015 cap increase represented a sustained funding shift, with distributions rising through 2018 before the fund balance began to decline. Shelters experienced different funding trajectories depending on CJCC allocation decisions, generating the within-shelter variation in government grant funding that the empirical analysis exploits.

3 Data Description

This section describes the data underlying the analysis. Section 3.1 describes the DV Shelter Database built from IRS Form 990 filings, the shelter-level panel used throughout. Sections 3.2–3.4 describe the three county-level data sources used to measure community violence and child maltreatment outcomes.

3.1 Domestic Violence Shelter Database

No publicly available, longitudinal, comprehensive database of DV shelters exists.⁴ Administrative alternatives are limited. The Criminal Justice Coordinating Council tracks only shelters receiving VOCA grants over a restricted set of years,⁵ and County Business Patterns (CBP) data aggregates DV shelters with family, youth, and homeless shelters, making DV shelters impossible to isolate.⁶

DV shelters are nonprofit organizations required to file an annual IRS Form 990, reporting mission and program descriptions and detailed financial information at the organization level. I use “DV shelter” to refer to the filing organization throughout, since Form 990 data are reported at the organization rather than program level. For most organizations, the shelter and its directly related services constitute the organization’s core mission, though for a small number the shelter is one program within a larger, unrelated nonprofit. I use these annual filings to construct a novel dataset of DV shelters in Georgia from 2013–2023, cross-validated against independent sources, identifying 47 DV shelters operating in Georgia with continuous annual observations and detailed financial information.

I build the panel in three steps. First, I start with the universe of tax-exempt filers, roughly one million organizations, and filter to those classified as providing human or health services. I use Optical Character Recognition (OCR) to extract mission and program

⁴Many shelters avoid public disclosure of their location and operations for victim safety reasons.

⁵Four DV shelters receive no government grants in at least one sample year.

⁶CBP data shows four Georgia counties opening their first shelter during the sample period. Two of these already had a DV shelter operating according to 990 data. CBP data are drawn from Census Bureau (2023) and compared against the DV Shelter Database for Georgia, 2013–2023.

statements from each organization’s two most recent 990 filings⁷ and flag any organization mentioning DV-related terms, derived from a review of 990 filings for shelters identified through an independent online search (Appendix A.1).

Second, I use a Large Language Model (LLM) to extract structured data from each flagged organization’s 990 filings, trained on 30 filings per field, such as total revenue, program service expenses, officer compensation, and mission statement text, across the range of 990 form variants, and validated out-of-sample before deployment. This generates an initial extraction of the address and the programming and financial variables used throughout the paper.⁸ The recorded address is the organization’s business address, typically a PO box rather than the physical shelter location, consistent with standard safety practices.⁹ I assign each shelter to this address’s county. All extracted records were manually reviewed, with missing or unclear entries corrected by hand.

Finally, I cross-validate the resulting shelter list against point-in-time snapshots from the CJCC, DomesticShelter.org, and the GCADV, using the Internet Archive’s Wayback Machine and archived news reports to identify when organizations began or ended shelter services. This process identifies 48 DV shelters operating in Georgia during the sample period. One, a large national nonprofit whose parent files a consolidated Form 990 without program-level financials, cannot be identified in the 990 data and is excluded entirely. Another is identifiable but operates as a small program within a large, multi-service nonprofit whose finances are dominated by other activities. Because its financials are not comparable to those of stand-alone shelters, it is excluded from the financial analysis. The final analysis panel includes 46 shelters. No shelter opens or closes during the sample period.

Government grants are allocated on the federal fiscal year, beginning October 1st. Because shelters define their own fiscal years, I assign each 990 filing to the federal grant

⁷Only two years were used for computational feasibility. Organizations serving DV victims typically retain DV-specific language in their mission statements over time. Any providers whose two most recent filings lack this language remain recoverable through cross-validation and archival review.

⁸The complete list of extracted variables is reported in Appendix A.2.

⁹Where shelter websites report the county of physical operation, this county matches the recorded 990 address county in every case.

award year using this start date. For example, a shelter filing for fiscal year June 2013–June 2014 is assigned to award year 2013, capturing the October 1, 2013 grant allocation. The treatment variable thus reflects the federal funding cycle driving variation in the data.

3.2 Uniform Crime Reporting Supplemental Homicide Reports

DV homicide data come from the FBI’s Uniform Crime Reporting Supplemental Homicide Reports (UCR-SHR), covering all homicides reported to Georgia law enforcement from 2013–2019 (Federal Bureau of Investigation, 2013–2019). The sample ends in 2019 to align with the HCUP and NCANDS data described below, which are also available only through that year. This also avoids contamination from the pandemic-era rise in domestic violence, since stay-at-home orders are documented to have increased domestic violence by confining victims with abusers for extended periods (Leslie & Wilson, 2020), and the same period saw a sharp decline in CVF deposits that reduced VOCA-funded victim assistance grants nationally (Office for Victims of Crime, 2026).

The UCR-SHR includes victim and perpetrator characteristics and their relationship, allowing DV-related incidents to be identified. I construct four measures of lethal violence. DV homicides are incidents where the perpetrator is a sibling, parent, grandparent, child, or current or past intimate partner; IPV homicides restrict to current or past intimate partners. Lethal violence is rare but widely studied, since it is less under-reported than non-lethal DV. However, DV and IPV measures still rely on accurate relationship coding, which is sometimes missing or unknown, potentially undercounting true DV and IPV homicides. I therefore construct two additional measures that do not rely on relationship coding: homicides of female victims ages 18–34, the age range with the highest intimate partner violence rates (Black et al., 2011), and homicides of victims under 18, to measure lethal violence against children. DV and IPV homicides are scaled per 100,000 total county population, female homicides per 100,000 female county population ages 18–34, and child homicides per 100,000 county population under 18.

3.3 HCUP Emergency Department and Inpatient Discharge Records

I use Healthcare Cost and Utilization Project (HCUP) Emergency Department and Inpatient Discharge Records (Healthcare Cost and Utilization Project, 2013–2019) to examine violence identified through hospital contact, a broader and more prevalent set of cases. The data cover the universe of Georgia hospital discharges from 2013–2019 at the discharge-record level, observing year, patient zip code, sex, age, and up to 25 diagnostic codes per discharge.

I construct three measures of DV-related hospital utilization. IPV and DV discharges use cause-of-injury diagnostic codes identifying physical, sexual, psychological, and financial abuse.¹⁰ A third measure counts assault discharges for female patients ages 18–34 regardless of relationship coding (Aizer, 2010; Geddes & Holz, 2026), and is therefore less sensitive to variation in how abuse is classified. Abuse-coded discharges can reflect underlying violence, help-seeking behavior, or practitioner beliefs. All measures are aggregated to the county-fiscal-year level using patient zip code of residence,¹¹ with DV and IPV discharges scaled per 100,000 total county population and female assault discharges per 100,000 female county population ages 18–34.

3.4 National Child Abuse and Neglect Data System

Child maltreatment data come from the National Child Abuse and Neglect Data System (NCANDS), the universe of child abuse and neglect reports submitted to state child protective services agencies (U.S. Department of Health and Human Services, 2013–2019). I use Georgia data from 2013–2019, with complete statewide county coverage, aggregated to the county-fiscal-year level using the county to which each report was first assigned for investigation, corresponding to the child’s county of residence.¹²

¹⁰Diagnostic codes follow ICD-9 classification through Q3 2015 and ICD-10 thereafter. Abuse codes are not mutually exclusive.

¹¹This attributes discharge records to the victim’s locality rather than the treating facility’s locality.

¹²Four counties with operating DV shelters (Habersham, Henry, Troup, and Whitfield) are served by a DFCS office that also handles cases from a neighboring county, so the county of assignment may not always match the child’s actual county of residence.

I construct three measures: substantiated child abuse and neglect reports per county-year; reports in which foster care was provided as a post-response service (any out-of-home placement exceeding 24 hours), a measure of severe family disruption; and reports in which domestic violence is flagged as present in the home, regardless of whether the child is the direct victim or the report is substantiated, reflecting children’s potential exposure to DV even absent confirmed direct maltreatment. All three measures are scaled per 100,000 county population under 18.

Table 1: Violence Outcomes Descriptive Statistics

Variable	N	Mean	SD	Min	Max
<i>Panel A: UCR Homicide Reports</i>					
IPV homicides ^a	308	0.625	1.226	0	9.346
DV homicides ^a	308	1.017	1.484	0	9.346
Female homicides ^b	308	2.740	6.776	0	57.400
Child homicides ^c	308	1.462	3.379	0	31.197
<i>Panel B: HCUP Hospital Discharges</i>					
IPV discharges ^a	308	6.059	6.319	0	32.069
DV discharges ^a	308	12.860	12.234	0	76.192
Female assault discharges ^b	308	536.454	257.097	77.027	1402.761
<i>Panel C: NCANDS Child Maltreatment Reports^c</i>					
Substantiated reports, infants	308	103.741	78.473	0	353.029
Substantiated reports, ages 1–3	308	126.470	108.880	0	518.176
Substantiated reports, ages 4–10	308	265.663	227.729	0	1002.753
Substantiated reports, ages 11–18	308	167.676	139.174	0	709.503
Substantiated reports, all ages	308	663.551	531.173	0	2511.162
DV risk factor	308	225.736	228.304	0	1283.101
Foster care services	308	202.576	161.734	0	741.361

Notes: Observations are at the county-fiscal-year level; the data cover 2013–2019. All rates are per 100,000. ^aScaled by total county population. ^bScaled by female population ages 18–34. ^cScaled by county population under 18.

Table 1 reports descriptive statistics for the violence and child maltreatment out-

comes, all measured at the county-fiscal-year level over 2013–2019. IPV and DV homicide and discharge measures are scaled by total county population; female homicide and assault measures by female population ages 18–34; and child homicide and NCANDS measures by county population under 18. Homicides are rare events—mean county-year IPV homicide counts are under one—while hospitalization rates show substantially greater cross-county variation.

A Note on Sample Periods

The data sources cover different periods. The 990 shelter panel covers 2013–2023. UCR homicide, HCUP discharge, and NCANDS data cover 2013–2019, the years for which the HCUP and NCANDS data are available. This period also predates the pandemic-era disruptions to both violence and hospital utilization. Results should be interpreted in light of the funding environment and sample period relevant to each outcome.

4 The Georgia DV Shelter Landscape

This section characterizes the Georgia DV shelter sector descriptively, using the 990 panel introduced in Section 3 together with CJCC administrative records on shelter service utilization, introduced below. Section 4.1 characterizes shelter locations and financial trends using the 990 panel. Section 4.2 describes the CJCC administrative data. Section 4.3 uses these records to characterize the range of services Georgia shelters provide.

4.1 Shelter Distribution and Financial Trends

Georgia’s 48 DV shelters operate across 45 of the state’s 159 counties, with DeKalb County the only county served by multiple shelters. Among the state’s metropolitan counties (RUCC codes 1–3), 26 of 74 (35 percent) host at least one shelter, compared with 16 percent of small-town and rural counties (RUCC codes 6–9). Table 2 reports baseline characteristics

for shelter and non-shelter counties prior to the 2015 CVF expansion. Shelter counties are roughly twice as populous as non-shelter counties on average, with modestly higher incomes and lower poverty rates, consistent with shelters concentrating in urban areas. Racial composition is nearly identical across groups. Baseline female homicide and assault hospitalization rates are somewhat lower in shelter counties, though not statistically different. These patterns are consistent with shelters locating in more populous areas rather than areas with higher baseline violence.

Table 2: County Characteristics by Shelter Presence (Pre-2016)

	No Shelter ($N = 114$)		Shelter ($N = 45$)		
	Mean	SD	Mean	SD	Difference
<i>Demographics</i>					
Total population	69,074	176,443	123,397	141,928	54,232*** (19,277)
Per capita income (\$)	33,000	7,527	34,484	6,414	1,483* (842)
Median HH income (\$)	42,402	10,787	45,869	12,663	3,466** (1,421)
Poverty rate (%)	22.13	6.89	20.29	6.78	-1.84** (0.82)
Percent female (%)	50.83	2.19	51.19	1.37	0.36* (0.22)
Percent white (%)	68.38	15.60	68.16	19.46	-0.22 (2.13)
<i>Baseline violence rates</i>					
Female homicide (per 100k Female 18-34)	4.39	11.90	3.73	7.59	-0.65 (1.25)
Female assault discharges (per 100k Female 18-34)	565.54	289.37	545.73	247.64	-19.81 (32.44)

Notes: Means are computed over county-year observations from 2013–2015, prior to the 2015 CVF expansion. The difference column reports the shelter-county mean minus the no-shelter-county mean, with heteroskedasticity-robust standard errors from a county-year OLS regression in parentheses. Female homicide and assault discharge rates are per 100,000 female population ages 18–34. Female assault discharge rates are per 100,000 female population ages 18–34. *** $p < 0.01$, ** $p < 0.05$, * $p < 0.10$.

Figure 1 shows the geographic distribution of government grant funding in 2013 and its change between 2013 and 2018. Funding levels vary substantially across shelters at baseline, and grant trajectories differ considerably over the sample period.

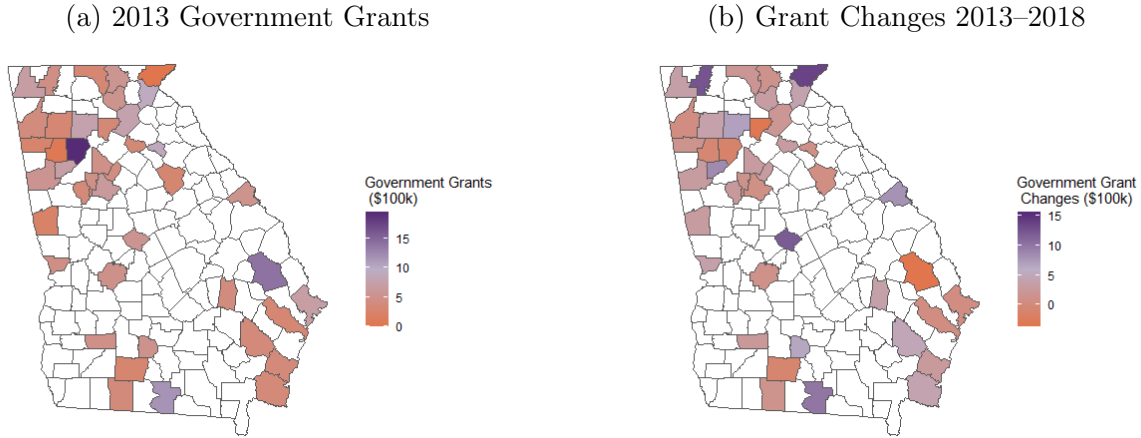


Figure 1: Government Grant Distribution and Changes Across Georgia DV Shelters

Notes: The left panel depicts the total government grants for each DV shelter in Georgia during the 2013 fiscal year. The right panel depicts the change in government grants between 2013 and 2018. Counties in white do not have a DV shelter operating. Houston County (Warner Robins) has a DV shelter operating but is excluded from the financial analysis because the shelter is a small program within a large, multi-service Georgia nonprofit whose financials are not comparable to those of stand-alone DV shelters. Data come from the DV Shelter Database.

Georgia’s shelter funding grew substantially over the sample period, as shown in Table 3. Mean total revenue rose 86 percent, from \$974,449 in 2013 to \$1,814,542 in 2023, and government grants grew similarly (+87 percent, \$631,170 to \$1,177,207). Private contributions also rose (+82 percent). Expenditures tracked revenue closely, with total expenditure rising 83 percent and compensation, the largest expenditure category, rising 86 percent. Employee counts grew more modestly (+36 percent, 22.5 to 30.6 on average), while reported volunteer counts declined 49 percent—a figure that should be interpreted cautiously given inconsistent reporting of this field across organizations and years.

Table 3: Georgia DV Shelter Financial Characteristics, 2013 and 2023

	2013		2023		% Change
	Mean	Median [p25, p75]	Mean	Median [p25, p75]	(Mean)
<i>Revenue (\$1,000s)</i>					
Total Revenue	974.4	733.0 [527.9, 1,089.4]	1,814.5	1,389.7 [944.2, 2,119.8]	+86%
Government Grants	631.2	473.0 [356.4, 704.0]	1,177.2	860.0 [617.6, 1,419.8]	+87%
Private Donations	256.6	128.7 [71.4, 242.6]	466.6	270.1 [153.8, 544.0]	+82%
Program Service Revenue	32.5	0.0 [0.0, 5.5]	60.1	0.0 [0.0, 0.0]	+85%
Other Revenue	75.4	26.0 [1.3, 112.3]	110.6	52.0 [13.5, 163.8]	+47%
<i>Expenditure (\$1,000s)</i>					
Total Expenditure	894.8	705.4 [507.3, 1,021.5]	1,634.5	1,253.7 [888.6, 1,954.4]	+83%
Compensation	510.1	424.0 [323.4, 566.9]	947.3	796.0 [553.3, 1,057.6]	+86%
Fee-for-Service	37.9	5.0 [0.0, 21.7]	45.3	15.7 [2.4, 35.8]	+20%
Operations	29.0	14.9 [5.4, 27.5]	70.5	23.6 [11.7, 81.4]	+143%
Occupancy	52.2	44.5 [21.2, 60.3]	87.8	70.5 [48.9, 122.3]	+68%
Fundraising	35.6	8.1 [0.0, 19.3]	87.9	14.3 [0.0, 41.4]	+147%
Other Expenditure	239.7	163.5 [85.0, 288.4]	395.6	400.3 [186.7, 570.2]	+65%
<i>Staffing (count)</i>					
Employees	22.5	23.0 [15.5, 27.0]	30.6	28.5 [20.0, 37.0]	+36%
Volunteers	78.5	69.0 [25.0, 96.0]	39.7	27.5 [22.0, 50.0]	−49%

Notes: Each observation is a shelter-year. Sample size ranges from 43–47 shelters for revenue and expenditure variables and 26–46 for staffing variables, depending on item-level missingness in Form 990 filings; the analysis sample includes 46 shelters with available Form 990 data for the relevant year, plus one additional shelter excluded due to consolidated multi-service financials. Dollar figures are in thousands. Percent change is computed as the change in the cross-sectional mean from 2013 to 2023. Program Service Revenue has a median and 75th percentile of zero in both years, indicating that the majority of shelters report no revenue from this source; the small positive mean reflects a subset of shelters with fee-based programming. Volunteer counts should be interpreted with caution: the number of shelters reporting volunteers declined from 31 in 2013 to 26 in 2023, and volunteer reporting on Form 990 is inconsistent across organizations and years.

4.2 CJCC Administrative Records

The CJCC, the state agency responsible for distributing federal grant funds to DV shelters in Georgia, requires grant recipients to report program statistics. I obtained annual shelter-level records through a direct data request, covering 46 of the 47 shelters in the 990 database. The remaining shelter operates without government funding and is not a CJCC subgrantee.¹³ The data contain victim counts beginning in 2017, with a breakdown by service type from 2018–2022, across 40 distinct service categories such as emergency housing, case management, and legal aid. I examine service provision using three measures: total people served per shelter-year, people served by service type, and whether each service is offered. Victim counts may include duplicates, since an individual receiving multiple services or using more than one shelter in the same year is counted multiple times. These figures should therefore be read as counts of service instances rather than unique individuals served.

4.3 Service Provision Across Georgia Shelters, 2018–2022

I use the CJCC service records described in Section 4.2 to characterize which services Georgia shelters provide during 2018–2022, the period for which shelter-by-service data are available. This period follows the 2015 CVF cap increase described in Section 2.2. I characterize service provision for this period only. The patterns below should not be extended to the full 2013–2023 sample used elsewhere in the paper.

For each of 39 individual services,¹⁴ I construct two shelter-level measures: whether a shelter offers the service at any point during 2018–2022, and whether a shelter offers the service in every year it is observed. All 46 shelters with CJCC service records offer the same fourteen services at some point during this period: a staffed crisis line, crisis coordination, safe housing, emergency and non-emergency legal assistance, emergency financial assistance, assistance applying for Temporary Assistance for Needy Families (TANF) and other govern-

¹³This shelter is included in all 990-based financial analyses but excluded from the utilization analysis.

¹⁴I exclude one additional catch-all category, “Other Service Provided,” because no shelter reports offering it during the sample period.

ment benefits, individual support, support groups, interagency advocacy, referral services, relocation assistance, transportation assistance, and criminal-justice-system advocacy. Table 4 reports the offering rates underlying this comparison. At the other end of the distribution, four services are offered by fewer than one-fifth of shelters at any point during the sample period: attorney-provided immigration assistance and three categories of forensic medical examination. These services plausibly require partnerships with credentialed providers, such as immigration attorneys or Sexual Assault Nurse Examiners, that most shelters do not maintain in-house.

The remaining services fall between these two groups. Offering rates vary substantially across shelters even within this middle range. Civil legal attorney assistance for family law, for example, is offered by 71.7 percent of shelters at some point during the sample period but by only 6.5 percent of shelters in every year they are observed, a gap of 65 percentage points. Group therapy shows a similar pattern: 58.7 percent of shelters offer it at some point, compared with 4.3 percent that offer it every year.

This gap between ever offering a service and offering it consistently is not limited to less common services. Even among the fourteen near-universal services, the share of shelters offering a service in every observed year is substantially lower than the share offering it in at least one year. All 46 shelters offer Support Group at some point, but only 84.8 percent offer it every year. All 46 offer assistance applying for TANF and other government benefits at some point, but only 63.0 percent offer it every year. Within-shelter service offerings therefore fluctuate from year to year rather than remaining fixed, even for services offered nearly universally at some point during the sample period.

I also examine the number of victims served annually through each service. Even among the fourteen near-universal services, annual victim counts vary widely across shelters. Shelters report serving an average of 7,599 victims annually through Individual Support. The standard deviation, 9,926, exceeds the mean, reflecting large differences in scale across shelters. Table 4 reports mean victims served for the near-universal and least-common

service categories. The full 39-service breakdown, including offering rates and victims served for every service, appears in Appendix Table 25.

Table 4: Georgia Shelter Service Provision, 2018–2022

Service	Ever Offered (%)	Always Offered (%)	Mean Victims/Yr
<i>Panel A: Near-Universal Services (offered by all 46 shelters)</i>			
Crisis Line	100.0	95.7	2,017
Individual Support	100.0	95.7	7,599
Referral to Services, Support, Resources	100.0	95.7	1,107
Safe Housing	100.0	91.3	3,684
Transportation Assistance	100.0	93.5	1,297
Support Group	100.0	84.8	617
Non-Emergency Legal Assistance	100.0	73.9	523
Interagency Advocacy	100.0	76.1	823
Emergency Legal Assistance	100.0	73.9	801
Emergency Financial Assistance	100.0	69.6	178
Criminal Justice Support/Advocacy	100.0	69.6	327
Relocation Assistance	100.0	67.4	210
Crisis Coordination	100.0	60.9	2,581
TANF/Government Benefits Assistance	100.0	63.0	110
<i>Panel B: Least-Common Services (offered by fewer than 20% of shelters)</i>			
Performance of Initial Forensic Medical Exam	19.6	8.7	9.4
Performance of Forensic Interview	17.4	8.7	8.8
Performance of Follow-Up Forensic Medical Exam	17.4	2.2	0.7
Immigration Assistance–Attorney	13.0	0.0	6.9

Notes: Sample includes 46 shelters with CJCC service records, 2018–2022 ($N = 230$ shelter-years). “Ever Offered” is the share of shelters offering the service in at least one sample year; “Always Offered” is the share offering it in every year observed. Mean victims/year is the shelter-year average. Data come from CJCC utilization reports. The full 39-service breakdown appears in Appendix Table 25.

5 Empirical Strategy

The empirical strategy exploits within-shelter variation in government grant funding over time. Figure 2 shows the distribution of annual government grants across Georgia DV shelters from 2013 to 2023, with one box-and-whisker plot per year. The median grant level roughly doubles between 2013–2015 and 2016–2023, with the shift visible beginning in 2016 as additional federal funds were disbursed. The interquartile range also widens after 2015, not evidence of a uniform increase across shelters.

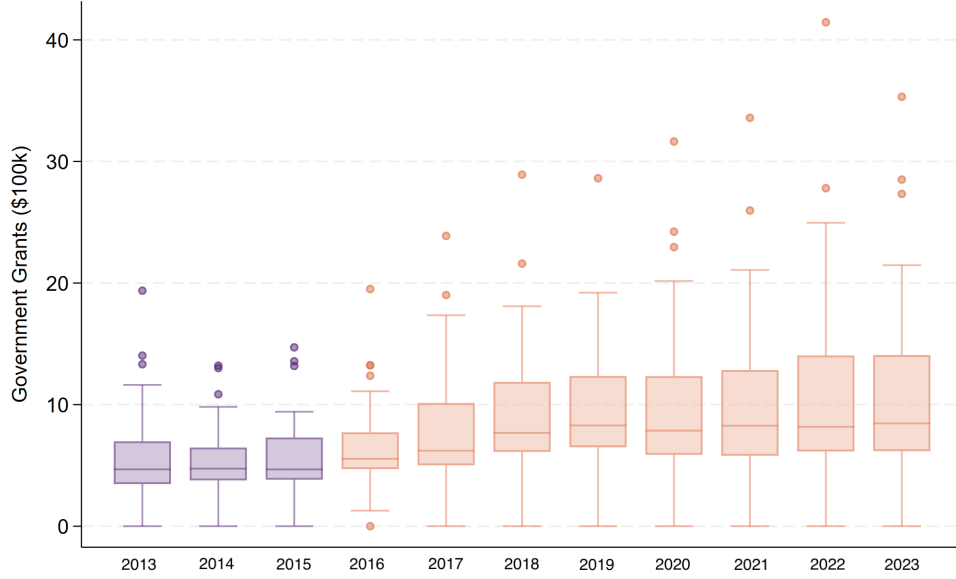


Figure 2: Distribution of Annual Government Grants, 2013–2023

Notes: The figure shows the distribution of annual government grants across Georgia DV shelters from 2013 to 2023, with one box-and-whisker plot per year. Each box spans the interquartile range (25th to 75th percentile) of grant funding in that year, with the horizontal line marking the median; whiskers extend to the most extreme values within 1.5 times the interquartile range, and points beyond this range are plotted individually as outliers. Purple boxes indicate the pre-cap-increase period (2013–2015) and orange boxes indicate the post-cap-increase period (2016–2023). Grants are measured in \$100,000s.

5.1 Two-Way Fixed Effects

The primary estimating equation is a two-way fixed effects (TWFE) regression:

$$Y_{it} = \beta_1 \cdot (\text{Grants}/\$100\text{k})_{it} + \beta_2 \cdot (\text{Grants}/\$100\text{k})_{i,t-1} + \alpha_i + \gamma_t + \varepsilon_{it}, \quad (1)$$

where Y_{it} is the outcome for shelter or county i in fiscal year t . Shelter-level outcomes come from the DV shelter database; county-level outcomes are the DV and child maltreatment measures. α_i denotes shelter or county fixed effects absorbing time-invariant characteristics such as mission focus or geographic service area; γ_t denotes year fixed effects accounting for aggregate shocks affecting all units in a given year. Standard errors are clustered at the shelter or county level. For county-level specifications, I aggregate shelter grant funding to

the county level; DeKalb County, the only county with multiple shelters, sums government grants across its shelters.

I include the one-period lag of grant funding for two reasons. First, shelters can carry unspent grant funds into the following fiscal year; without the lag, current expenditures financed by prior-year grants would be misattributed to current-year funding, overstating β_1 . Second, aligning shelters' Form 990 fiscal years to the October 1st federal grant award year (Section 3) means a grant awarded in one federal fiscal year may appear on a shelter's 990 filing for an adjacent fiscal year, depending on the shelter's own fiscal year-end. Both sources of delay mean that β_1 alone captures only part of a shelter's response to a funding change.

I therefore report the contemporaneous effect β_1 , the lagged effect β_2 , and their combined effect $\beta_1 + \beta_2$ throughout the paper, treating the sum as the primary quantity of interest. $\beta_1 + \beta_2$ is the effect on year t 's outcome of grant levels that are \$100,000 higher in both year t and year $t - 1$, relative to what each year's grant level would otherwise have been. This comparison places no restriction on the relationship between the two years' counterfactual grant levels. The increase in year $t - 1$ need not be sustained into year t , and grant levels prior to $t - 1$ do not enter the comparison. I assess the sum's significance with a Wald test of the linear combination $\beta_1 + \beta_2$.

Equation (1) is estimated separately for three outcome categories: (i) revenue and expenditure, (ii) organizational outcomes, and (iii) county-level violence and child maltreatment.

5.2 Identification

The setting differs from much of the recent difference-in-differences literature because treatment is continuous.¹⁵ I use TWFE with a lagged control as the baseline specification. Recovering a causal interpretation of β_1 and $\beta_1 + \beta_2$ requires four conditions, described below

¹⁵Appendix D discusses why continuous-treatment estimators developed for staggered binary designs are not well suited to this setting.

alongside the evidence used to assess each.

5.2.1 Assumptions

Parallel trends. Shelters with different levels of government grant funding would have evolved similarly absent treatment. With continuous treatment this is stronger than the standard binary-treatment version: units receiving different funding doses must follow parallel paths absent the variation in grants. This assumption would be violated if CJCC directs more funding toward shelters in counties with higher DV rates, worsening trends, or greater organizational need. Because CJCC’s allocation criteria are not publicly documented, I assess this assumption empirically below.

Linearity. The specification assumes a linear dose-response relationship, which would be violated by diminishing returns once a shelter’s core needs are met, or increasing returns if small grants are insufficient to finance meaningful change.

Homogeneous treatment effects. The specification assumes a given funding increase has a constant effect across shelters and over time, which would fail if, for example, larger or more established shelters convert additional funding into program expansion more effectively than smaller shelters.

I relax the linearity and homogeneity assumptions by estimating the model separately by baseline shelter size, allowing the dose-response relationship and treatment effects to vary across the size distribution without imposing a specific functional form. The tercile-specific estimates in Section 6.4 rest on the same parallel trends assumption as the pooled specification, applied within each tercile.

Limited carryover. The specification assumes a grant’s effect is confined to the year received and the following year, relaxing the stronger assumption needed in a no-lag model, which would require full within-year conversion of each grant into outcomes.

5.2.2 Evidence

Two pieces of evidence support the parallel trends assumption, following Alexander and Schnell (2024).

First, I estimate balancing regressions using equation (1) with county-level determinants of DV and lagged DV incidents as outcomes. Table 5 shows no evidence that government funds are targeted toward shelters in counties with more at-risk populations or higher prior DV rates, though a balancing test of this kind cannot rule out targeting on unobserved characteristics.

Second, I estimate an event study around the earliest post-expansion funding change. Let $\Delta\text{Grants}_i = \text{Grants}_{i,2016} - \text{Grants}_{i,2015}$. I use 2016 because it is the first year the sustained VOCA funding shift appears in shelter-level grant data, minimizing the extent to which pre-period coefficients capture the funding increase itself. Not all shelters receive their largest funding change in 2016, given the idiosyncratic nature of CJCC allocation decisions. The event study therefore captures the dynamic response to shelters' earliest post-expansion funding change rather than the full trajectory of the sustained funding environment. I estimate:

$$Y_{it} = \sum_t \beta_t \cdot \Delta\text{Grants}_i \cdot \rho_t + \alpha_i + \gamma_t + \epsilon_{it} \quad (2)$$

where ρ_t are year indicators and β_t captures the differential trend for shelters with larger initial funding changes. Pre-period coefficients ($t < 2016$) test parallel trends; post-period coefficients trace the dynamic response.

Table 5: Balancing Regressions

	β	Mean
Total Births	-9.7666*** (2.6830)	2068.15 (2775.62)
Per Capita Income	74.9482 (70.3913)	37405.44 (7789.87)
Median HH Income	-87.9181 (101.9412)	49788.45 (14232.65)
Pct. in Poverty	-0.0192 (0.0598)	18.36 (6.49)
Unemployment Rate	-0.0008 (0.0207)	5.80 (1.93)
Pct. Female	0.0073 (0.0059)	51.29 (1.42)
Pct. White	0.0280 (0.0536)	66.20 (20.51)
Pct. Black	-0.0056 (0.0483)	28.82 (19.86)
Pct. Native American	-0.0024 (0.0025)	0.56 (0.23)
Pct. Asian	-0.0163 (0.0256)	2.35 (2.20)
Pct. Two or More Races	-0.0034 (0.0021)	1.93 (0.61)
Lagged IPV Homicide	0.0095 (0.0138)	0.76 (1.20)
Lagged DV Homicide	0.0226 (0.0166)	1.32 (1.51)
Lagged Female Homicide	0.0531 (0.0904)	3.13 (5.79)
Lagged IPV Discharges	0.0738 (0.1789)	5.81 (6.17)
Lagged DV Discharges	0.0779 (0.2739)	11.91 (11.88)
Lagged Assault Discharges	1.1144 (3.1787)	428.86 (203.94)

Notes: The table presents the associations between a \$100,000 increase in annual government grant funding for shelters and possible confounders. The coefficients are estimated using equation (1) with county and year fixed effects. County demographics come from the Census and Bureau of Labor Statistics, homicides are measured using UCR-SH, and discharges from the GA HCUP databases. DV incidents are lagged by a year to estimate the relationship between current funding and the previous year's violence.

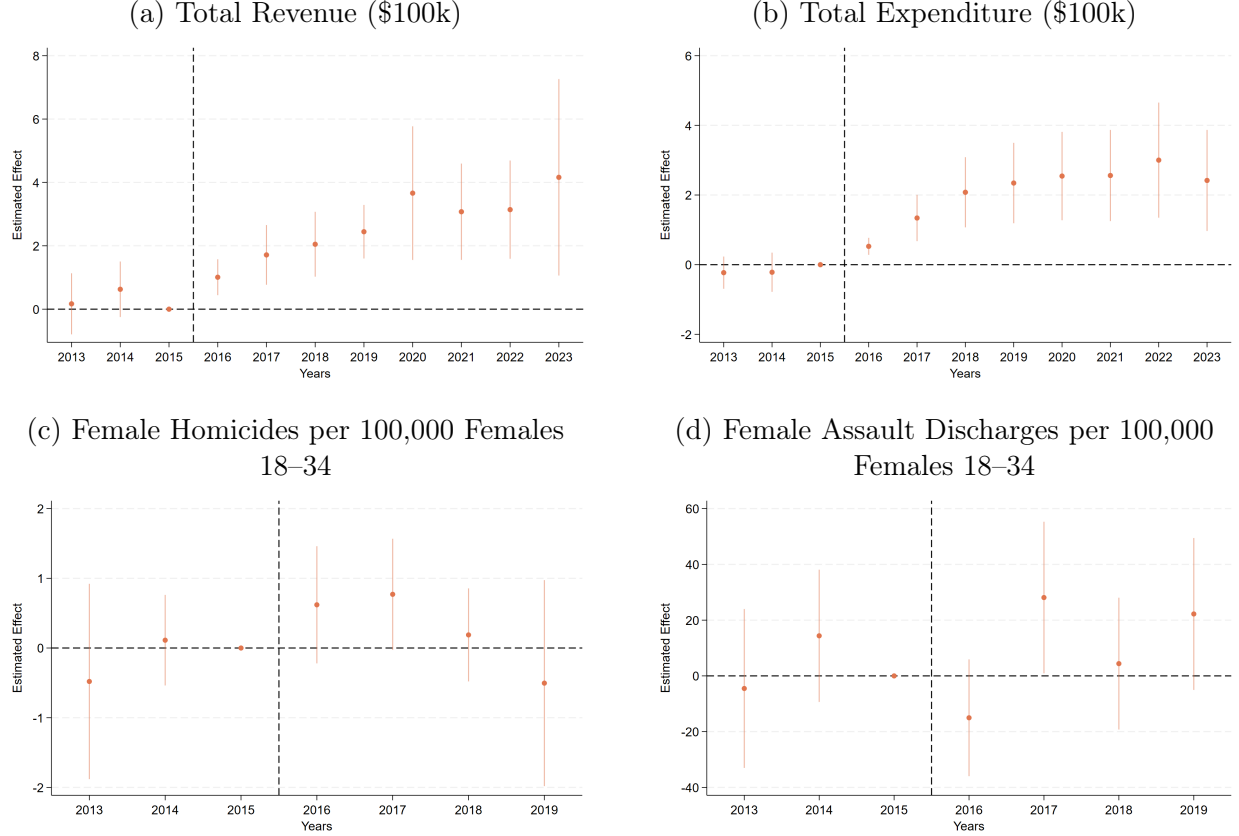


Figure 3: Event Study Estimates of 2016 Government Grant Change

Notes: The figures plot the coefficients and 95 percent confidence intervals on the interaction between the initial shelter grant change and year indicators from equation (2). Financial outcomes are drawn from the 990 DV shelter database and cover 2013–2023. Total revenue and expenditure are measured in \$100,000. Violence outcomes are drawn from GA HCUP discharge records and UCR-SH reports and cover 2013–2019. Event studies for all outcomes are reported in Appendix B.

Pre-period coefficients for the financial outcomes are small and statistically indistinguishable from zero, providing evidence in support of parallel trends for revenue and expenditure. Pre-period coefficients for the violence outcomes are imprecisely estimated, likely reflecting the rarity of county-level violence events, so their statistical insignificance provides weaker evidence for these specifications. However, the balance-table result, showing no correlation between current funding and lagged violence, provides complementary support here.

Finally, I decompose variation in grant funding into components explained by perma-

ment shelter differences, common year effects, and both. Table 6 shows shelter fixed effects alone account for 68.7 percent of variation, versus 13.5 percent for year fixed effects alone: grant funding varies primarily across shelters rather than as a common statewide expansion.

Table 6: Variance Decomposition of Grant Funding

Specification	R^2	N
(1) No fixed effects	0.000	494
(2) Shelter fixed effects	0.687	494
(3) Year fixed effects	0.135	494
(4) Shelter and year fixed effects	0.819	494

Notes: Standard errors clustered by shelter.

Additional evidence on the CJCC allocation process is presented in Appendix C. Grant funding is highly persistent within a shelter over time ($\hat{\rho} = 0.745$). The 2015 CVF expansion scaled up existing allocations rather than redirecting funding toward previously low-funded shelters. Lagged shelter finances predict current grant levels, an expected mechanical relationship since grants are themselves a component of revenue. This relationship does not extend to grant changes, the funding decisions CJCC actually makes each year. No observable measure of shelter finances, county violence, or county demographics predicts the size of a shelter’s annual grant change. Prior increases in county homicide rates do not predict larger future grant changes. Baseline funding levels and pre-2016 funding trends also fail to predict post-expansion growth. Together, this evidence supports treating CJCC allocation as unrelated to time-varying unobserved shelter or county characteristics.

6 Results

This section presents the main results. I first examine effects on shelter finances and staffing, then turn to community-level violence and child maltreatment.

6.1 Effects on Shelter Finances

The estimates in Table 7 show that a \$100,000 increase in government grants raises a shelter's revenue by \$61,900 in the same year and by \$99,700 when the increase is reflected in both the current and prior year's grant totals. Private donations decline by \$38,900 in the same year, but this decline does not persist. The combined two-year effect is \$800 and not statistically distinguishable from zero, in contrast to the nonprofit literature, where government grants are estimated to displace 70 to 75 cents of private giving per dollar (Andreoni & Payne, 2003, 2011). Private donations do fall as a share of total revenue, by 1.4 percentage points, consistent with no adjustment in giving alongside rising total revenue. The share of revenue from grants rises by 2.1 percentage points over the same comparison. Program and other revenue show no statistically distinguishable effect.

Table 7: Effects of Government Grants on DV Shelter Revenue

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)
	Revenue Level (\$100k)				Share of Total Revenue			
	Total Revenue	Private Donations	Program Revenue	Other Revenue	Grants	Private Donations	Program Revenue	Other Revenue
Grants (\$100k)	0.619*** (0.147)	-0.389** (0.161)	0.021 (0.022)	-0.013 (0.030)	0.031*** (0.007)	-0.027*** (0.007)	-0.000 (0.001)	-0.003 (0.002)
Grants (lagged)	0.378** (0.158)	0.397** (0.170)	0.008 (0.012)	-0.028 (0.036)	-0.010*** (0.003)	0.014*** (0.005)	0.001 (0.001)	-0.004 (0.004)
Sum ($\beta_1 + \beta_2$)	0.997*** (0.098)	0.008 (0.091)	0.030 (0.024)	-0.041 (0.034)	0.021*** (0.007)	-0.014** (0.006)	0.001 (0.001)	-0.008* (0.004)
Sample Mean	12.888	3.046	0.273	0.857	0.680	0.226	0.022	0.072
Observations	442	442	442	442	442	442	442	442

Notes: The table shows the estimated effects of a \$100,000 increase in government grants, while controlling for the prior year grant amount. Sum reports the linear combination $\beta_1 + \beta_2$. The standard error is computed via a Wald test and accounts for the covariance between the contemporaneous and lagged coefficients. Observations are at the shelter-fiscal-year level from 2013–2023. All regressions include shelter and year fixed effects. Private donations comprise fundraising event revenue and direct contributions (IRS Form 990 Part VIII lines 1c and 1f). Program revenue is reported on Part I of Form 990. Other revenue includes federated campaigns, membership dues, grants from other organizations, and miscellaneous receipts. Standard errors in parentheses are clustered at the shelter level. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

I next examine expenditure, reported in Table 8. A \$100,000 increase in grants raises total expenditure by \$57,300 in the same year and \$82,500 across both years. Revenue rises slightly faster than expenditure in both specifications: the same-year gap is 4.6 cents per grant dollar (61.9 cents of revenue versus 57.3 cents of expenditure), and this gap widens to 17.2 cents at the combined two-year level (99.7 versus 82.5 cents). This growing gap is consistent with shelters carrying an increasing share of grant funds forward rather than spending each year’s increase within the same two-year window. At the combined two-year level, organizations assign 86 percent of increased expenditure to their primary program, the functional category shelters use to classify their predominant service offerings.

I categorize total expenditure into six mutually exclusive bins (columns 3–8). Employee compensation rises by \$31,600 in the same year and \$43,100 across both years, and other expenditure rises by \$13,500 and \$19,900.¹⁶ Fee-for-service contract work rises by \$4,700 same-year ($p = 0.098$) and \$6,800 combined ($p = 0.056$), both coefficients only marginally significant. Occupancy expenditure shows no significant same-year effect, but a positive, significant combined two-year effect of \$3,100 ($p = 0.008$)—under 5 percent of the \$66,100 sample mean. Although occupancy expenditure can include costs associated with acquiring additional space, an increase of this magnitude is more consistent with incremental costs such as maintenance. Organizations direct roughly half of their increased expenditure toward staff compensation. Table 9 examines staffing further, presenting this result alongside additional measures of staff composition.

¹⁶Other expenditure includes any spending not captured in the five named categories. Because this category spans a wide range of spending types, I do not draw a strong conclusion from this result.

Table 8: Effects of Government Grants on DV Shelter Expenditure

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)
	Total	Primary	Compensation	Contract	Operations	Occupancy	Fundraising	Other
	Expenditure	Program		Work			Expenditure	
	(\$100k)							
Grants (\$100k)	0.573***	0.447***	0.316***	0.047*	0.034	-0.009	0.051	0.135**
	(0.069)	(0.063)	(0.050)	(0.028)	(0.024)	(0.021)	(0.040)	(0.059)
Grants (lagged)	0.252***	0.266***	0.116***	0.020	-0.001	0.040*	0.013	0.064
	(0.051)	(0.038)	(0.039)	(0.043)	(0.013)	(0.020)	(0.010)	(0.046)
Sum ($\beta_1 + \beta_2$)	0.825***	0.713***	0.431***	0.068*	0.033*	0.031***	0.064	0.199**
	(0.084)	(0.078)	(0.057)	(0.034)	(0.017)	(0.011)	(0.044)	(0.080)
Sample Mean	11.989	9.081	7.008	0.513	0.469	0.661	0.519	2.820
Observations	442	442	442	442	442	442	442	442

Notes: The table shows the estimated effects of a \$100,000 increase in government grants, while controlling for the prior year grant amount. Sum reports the linear combination $\beta_1 + \beta_2$. The standard error is computed via a Wald test and accounts for the covariance between the contemporaneous and lagged coefficients. Observations are at the shelter-fiscal-year level from 2013–2023. All regressions include shelter and year fixed effects. Compensation includes all W-2 employee compensation — officer and employee salaries, benefits, and payroll taxes (Form 990 Part IX lines 5–10) — and excludes contract workers. Contract work comprises all fee-for-service expenditure lines. Operations includes office, information technology, advertising, travel, and conference expenditures. Other is a residual category capturing supplies, maintenance, bank fees, and miscellaneous items; the six mutually exclusive categories sum to total expenditure by construction. Primary program expenditure reflects shelters’ own functional classification of spending directed toward service delivery and is not mutually exclusive with columns 3–8. Standard errors in parentheses are clustered at the shelter level. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

6.2 Effects on Staffing

Staff composition shapes both the support victims receive and the services a shelter can offer. Table 9 redisplayes the compensation and contract-work estimates from Table 8 (columns 1–2) alongside two measures of staff composition: employee count and volunteer count (columns 3–4). A \$100,000 increase in grants raises employee count by 0.411 in the same year and by 0.913 across both years, an increase of 1.5 and 3.4 percent of the sample mean, respectively. As a complementary check, I construct compensation per employee and find a marginally significant increase of \$701 same-year and \$335 combined. Volunteer count shows a negative

but statistically insignificant relationship with grants in both specifications.¹⁷ The volunteer regression is estimated on a smaller sample, since fewer shelters report volunteer counts consistently.

Taken together, employee count rises with grant funding, more precisely in the combined two-year specification than same-year alone. Compensation per employee shows a similar but noisier pattern, and volunteer count shows no comparable relationship. These results are consistent with an expansion in paid staffing capacity.

Table 9: Effects of Government Grants on DV Shelter Staffing

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
	Compensation	Contract	Employee	Volunteer	Compensation per
	(\$100k)	Work (\$100k)	Count	Count	Employee (\$100k)
Grants (\$100k)	0.316*** (0.050)	0.047* (0.028)	0.411* (0.207)	-1.319 (1.581)	0.007** (0.003)
Grants (lagged)	0.116*** (0.039)	0.020 (0.043)	0.503** (0.211)	-2.129* (1.082)	-0.004 (0.003)
Sum ($\beta_1 + \beta_2$)	0.431*** (0.057)	0.068* (0.034)	0.913*** (0.200)	-3.448 (2.055)	0.003* (0.002)
Sample Mean	7.008	0.513	27.24	53.98	0.25
Observations	442	442	370	150	340

Notes: The table shows the estimated effects of a \$100,000 increase in government grants, while controlling for the prior year grant amount. Sum reports the linear combination $\beta_1 + \beta_2$. The standard error is computed via a Wald test and accounts for the covariance between the contemporaneous and lagged coefficients. Observations are at the shelter-fiscal-year level from 2013–2023. All regressions include shelter and year fixed effects. Compensation includes all W-2 employee compensation — officer and employee salaries, benefits, and payroll taxes (Form 990 Part IX lines 5–10) — and excludes contract workers. Contract work comprises all fee-for-service expenditure lines and captures payments to independent contractors. Compensation per employee is constructed as total compensation divided by employee count. Standard errors in parentheses are clustered at the shelter level. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

¹⁷VOCA requires subgrantees to use volunteers as a condition of funding. This floor may limit how far shelters can reduce volunteer counts as paid staffing expands.

6.3 Effects on Violence Outcomes

Section 2 outlined three channels through which shelter funding could affect community-level violence: improving service quality for existing clients, expanding capacity to reach additional victims, or increasing outreach without expanding capacity. The staffing results in Section 6.2 show that shelters do expand capacity in response to funding. Whether this expanded capacity affects community-level violence, however, depends on which channel dominates.

I study county-year counts of DV-related hospital discharges, homicides, and child maltreatment reports, reported in Tables 10, 11, and 12. Because each table tests multiple outcomes, I apply a Benjamini-Hochberg correction within each data source to the combined two-year effect for each outcome.¹⁸

Table 10 reports effects on hospital discharge rates. Contemporaneous coefficients for IPV, DV, and female assault discharges are not statistically distinguishable from zero. For IPV and DV discharges, confidence intervals are wide relative to the sample mean, ruling out effects larger than roughly 5–8 percent. For female assault discharges, the confidence interval rules out contemporaneous effects larger than about 1.5 percent of the sample mean. The lagged coefficient for female assault discharges is positive and individually significant at 5 percent, an increase of roughly 0.5–3.2 percent of the sample mean, but the combined two-year effect is significant only at 10 percent and does not survive Benjamini-Hochberg correction across the three HCUP tests. Combined two-year effects for IPV and DV discharges remain statistically indistinguishable from zero.

¹⁸Corrections are computed separately by data source: 4 tests for UCR homicide measures, 3 for HCUP discharge measures, and 7 for NCANDS child maltreatment measures, applied to the combined two-year effect in each table. I use $q = 0.10$ to match the significance threshold used throughout this paper.

Table 10: Effects of Government Grants on Hospital Discharges

	(1)	(2)	(3)
	IPV Discharge	DV Discharge	Assault Discharge
	Rate per 100k	Rate per 100k	Rate per 100k
	Total County Population		Female Pop. 18–34
Grants (\$100k)	0.004	-0.058	-2.563
	(0.154)	(0.200)	(2.775)
Grants (lagged)	-0.105	0.012	9.799**
	(0.177)	(0.298)	(3.655)
Sum ($\beta_1 + \beta_2$)	-0.101	-0.046	7.236*
	(0.113)	(0.281)	(3.761)
Sample Mean	5.956	11.979	535.061
Observations	264	264	264

Notes: The table shows the estimated effects of a \$100,000 increase in government grants, while controlling for the prior year grant amount. Sum reports the linear combination $\beta_1 + \beta_2$, the effect of a \$100,000 increase in government grants in both the current and prior year (see Section 5), with its standard error in parentheses. The dependent variable in each column is a discharge rate expressed per 100,000 population. Corresponding Poisson estimates with a population exposure offset appear in Appendix Table 32. Column (1) identifies discharges with a cause-of-injury code for abuse with an identified perpetrator. Column (2) identifies any domestic violence discharge. Column (3) identifies assault discharges for women ages 18–34. Discharges are aggregated across emergency departments and inpatient facilities in Georgia. All regressions include county and year fixed effects. Standard errors clustered at the county level in parentheses. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

Table 11 reports effects on county-level homicide rates. The IPV homicide coefficients are opposite in sign and individually significant at 5 percent, an 11 percent contemporaneous decline paired with a similarly sized lagged increase. Their combined two-year effect, an increase of 0.0315 per 100,000, is not statistically distinguishable from zero even before correction. No combined two-year effect is statistically significant for the remaining homicide measures. The opposing IPV coefficients are consistent with two large, imprecisely estimated effects offsetting each other in the combined effect, rather than a stable relationship in either direction. No similar pattern appears in the other homicide measures, the discharge outcomes, or the child maltreatment outcomes.

Table 11: Effects of Government Grants on DV Homicides

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
	IPV Homicide	DV Homicide	Female Homicide	Child Homicide
	Total County Population		Female Pop. 18-34	Pop. Under 18
Grants (\$100k)	-0.064**	-0.007	-0.247	-0.036
	(0.030)	(0.068)	(0.258)	(0.061)
Grants (lagged)	0.096**	0.054	-0.038	0.010
	(0.046)	(0.064)	(0.206)	(0.089)
Sum ($\beta_1 + \beta_2$)	0.032	0.047	-0.285	-0.026
	(0.031)	(0.037)	(0.251)	(0.105)
Sample Mean	0.566	0.982	2.541	1.417
Observations	264	264	264	264

Notes: The table shows the estimated effects of a \$100,000 increase in government grants, while controlling for the prior year grant amount. Sum reports the linear combination $\beta_1 + \beta_2$, the effect of a \$100,000 increase in government grants in both the current and prior year (see Section 5), with its standard error in parentheses. The dependent variable in each column is a homicide rate expressed per 100,000 population. Corresponding Poisson estimates with a population exposure offset appear in Appendix Table 33. IPV, DV, and female homicide outcomes come from UCR-SH data identified by perpetrator codes and victim sex. Child homicide counts any homicide with a victim under age 18, regardless of perpetrator relationship. All regressions include county and year fixed effects. Standard errors clustered at the county level in parentheses.

* $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

Table 12 reports effects on substantiated child maltreatment reports, foster care placements, and household DV-flagged reports. The combined two-year effect is not statistically distinguishable from zero for all seven outcomes. The contemporaneous coefficient for substantiated reports among children ages 11–18 is individually significant at 10 percent, but as with the IPV homicide result, this individually significant coefficient does not correspond to a significant combined two-year effect.

Table 12: Effects of Government Grants on Child Maltreatment Reports

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)
	All Ages	Infant	Ages 1–3	Ages 4–10	Ages 11–18	DV Risk	Foster
	Substantiated Reports					Factor	Services
	Rate per 100k Population Under 18						
Grants (\$100k)	-8.834	-0.639	-1.704	-3.072	-3.419*	-2.565	-0.464
	(7.461)	(1.224)	(1.726)	(3.599)	(1.908)	(3.122)	(1.914)
Grants (lagged)	10.255	0.652	2.275	4.949	2.380	4.534	-0.305
	(10.431)	(1.279)	(2.124)	(4.769)	(2.876)	(3.982)	(1.947)
Sum ($\beta_1 + \beta_2$)	1.421	0.013	0.570	1.877	-1.039	1.969	-0.768
	(11.816)	(1.780)	(2.220)	(5.213)	(3.284)	(3.320)	(1.908)
Sample Mean	655.917	104.570	123.325	261.516	166.506	235.576	199.883
Observations	264	264	264	264	264	264	264

Notes: The table shows the estimated effects of a \$100,000 increase in government grants, while controlling for the prior year grant amount. Sum reports the linear combination $\beta_1 + \beta_2$, the effect of a \$100,000 increase in government grants in both the current and prior year (see Section 5), with its standard error in parentheses. The dependent variable in each column is a substantiated-report rate expressed per 100,000 county population under 18, except column (6), which uses the count of reports flagging domestic violence as present in the household regardless of substantiation. Corresponding Poisson estimates with a population exposure offset appear in Appendix Table 34. All regressions include county and year fixed effects. Standard errors clustered at the county level in parentheses. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

The combined two-year effect is not statistically significant for any violence or child maltreatment outcome examined in this section, after correcting for multiple testing. The estimates are too imprecise, or too inconsistent between the same-year and lagged coefficients, to distinguish improved service quality, expanded capacity, or outreach as the dominant mechanism.

6.4 Heterogeneity by Shelter Size

The aggregate results potentially mask heterogeneity across shelters of different sizes. I estimate equation 1 separately by baseline shelter size, defined by 2013 revenue terciles. Table 13 reports the resulting cutoffs and summary statistics for each tercile: small shelters have 2013 revenue below roughly \$565,000, medium shelters between \$573,000 and \$935,000, and large shelters above \$992,000.

Table 13: Size Tercile Cutoffs

Tercile	<i>N</i>	Total Revenue 2013			
		Mean	Std. Dev.	Min	Max
Small	16	\$440,218	\$112,917	\$179,782	\$564,403
Medium	15	\$724,836	\$109,233	\$572,625	\$935,437
Large	15	\$1,474,837	\$652,383	\$992,044	\$2,740,121

Notes: Terciles are defined based on each shelter’s total revenue in 2013.

Figure 4 shows that funding growth was not uniform across size groups, with medium and large shelters experiencing the largest changes in funding between 2013 and 2018. Because each tercile contains roughly 15 shelters, these estimates should be read as descriptive of how the association between grants and outcomes varies by shelter size.

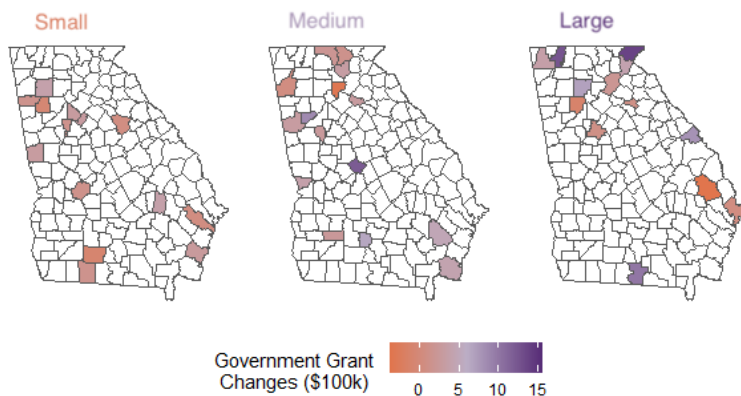


Figure 4: Grant Changes 2013–2018 Split by 2013 Revenue Tercile

Notes: This figure depicts the change in the total government grants for each DV shelter in Georgia between the 2013 and 2018 fiscal year. White counties do not have a DV shelter operating. Shelter sizes are defined by 2013 revenue terciles.

Tables 14–19 report the same-year coefficient, lagged coefficient, and combined two-year sum for each outcome and tercile. Because the three tercile regressions are estimated on non-overlapping shelters, the sums from different terciles are statistically independent, and I test whether the combined two-year effect differs across terciles using a pairwise z -test on each pair of tercile-specific sums. Full pairwise results for every outcome appear in Appendix F.

Four patterns emerge from splitting the results by shelter size: some effects are hidden entirely in the pooled estimate, some differ in magnitude but not existence, some differ in timing rather than magnitude, and one effect appears in a single size group only.

Pooled null, size-specific effect. For three outcomes, the pooled estimate is null but a pattern appears once the sample is split by size. The pooled effect on private donations is not statistically significant. Split by size, small shelters show a significant sustained decline of \$30,845, roughly 31 cents per grant dollar, while medium and large shelters show no comparable effect. The pooled effect on female assault hospital discharges is significant only at 10 percent and does not survive multiple-testing correction. Split by size, medium shelters show a large, significant combined two-year effect (28.91 per 100,000 female population ages 18–34), significantly different from large shelters’ near-zero effect ($p = 0.041$) but not from small shelters’ ($p = 0.492$). The pooled effect on female homicide is not significant but in this specification, small shelters show a significant combined-year decline (-1.874 per 100,000) while large shelters show a significant combined-year increase (0.158 per 100,000). These opposing effects potentially offset each other in the pooled estimate.

Pass-through rate varies by size. The pass-through rate from grants to revenue and expenditure varies by shelter size. For total revenue, a \$100,000 increase raises revenue by 65.3 cents same-year for small shelters, 108.1 cents for medium, and 33.7 cents for large. The combined two-year effect is 52.1 cents for small, 105.5 for medium, and 93.1 for large. Medium shelters’ combined revenue effect differs significantly from small shelters’ ($p = 0.014$) and marginally from large shelters’ ($p = 0.080$); small and large are not significantly different from

each other. Medium shelters are also the only group whose combined revenue effect exceeds the grant dollar itself. Decomposing this excess into private donations, program service revenue, and other revenue, none of the three combined effects is individually significant. These results are consistent with the increased revenue being spread across multiple sources. Small shelters' grant revenue share rises significantly less than medium or large shelters' ($p = 0.012$ and $p = 0.028$), and their other-revenue share falls significantly while medium and large show no comparable change ($p = 0.012$ and $p = 0.021$).

Table 14: Effects of Government Grants on DV Shelter Revenue by Shelter Size

		Revenue Level (\$100k)				Share of Total Revenue			
		Total Revenue	Private Donations	Program Revenue	Other Revenue	Grants	Private Donations	Program Revenue	Other Revenue
Small	β_1	0.653*** (0.204)	-0.342 (0.227)	0.004 (0.004)	-0.009 (0.035)	0.060** (0.022)	-0.054* (0.031)	0.000 (0.001)	-0.007 (0.010)
	β_2	-0.132 (0.091)	0.033 (0.149)	0.011 (0.010)	-0.177 (0.116)	0.007 (0.012)	0.019 (0.019)	0.002 (0.001)	-0.028** (0.012)
	Sum	0.521** (0.203)	-0.308** (0.111)	0.016 (0.012)	-0.186* (0.094)	0.067*** (0.021)	-0.035 (0.027)	0.002 (0.002)	-0.035** (0.014)
Medium	β_1	1.081*** (0.102)	0.067 (0.114)	-0.014 (0.010)	0.028 (0.024)	0.024* (0.011)	-0.019 (0.013)	-0.003* (0.001)	-0.003 (0.004)
	β_2	-0.026 (0.161)	-0.067 (0.155)	0.022 (0.037)	0.019 (0.034)	-0.011 (0.012)	0.004 (0.012)	0.004 (0.004)	0.003 (0.004)
	Sum	1.055*** (0.079)	-0.000 (0.080)	0.008 (0.036)	0.047 (0.029)	0.013** (0.005)	-0.015** (0.006)	0.002 (0.004)	0.001 (0.003)
Large	β_1	0.337* (0.182)	-0.670** (0.230)	0.039 (0.041)	-0.031 (0.055)	0.030*** (0.005)	-0.028*** (0.006)	-0.000 (0.001)	-0.002 (0.003)
	β_2	0.594** (0.210)	0.592** (0.244)	-0.003 (0.018)	0.005 (0.048)	-0.011*** (0.002)	0.011** (0.004)	-0.000 (0.001)	-0.000 (0.003)
	Sum	0.931*** (0.117)	-0.078 (0.116)	0.035 (0.034)	-0.026 (0.035)	0.019*** (0.006)	-0.017*** (0.005)	-0.000 (0.001)	-0.002 (0.003)

Notes: The table reports the estimated effects of a \$100,000 increase in government grants, separately by baseline shelter size tercile (2013 total revenue). β_1 is the same-year coefficient, β_2 the lagged coefficient, and Sum their combined two-year effect; standard errors in parentheses, with the Sum row's standard error computed via a Wald test. Column definitions match Table 7. All regressions include shelter and year fixed effects, estimated separately within each tercile; standard errors clustered at the shelter level. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

Total and primary program expenditure follow a similar ordering, with medium shelters again showing the largest combined pass-through: 107.8 cents for total expenditure and 94.3 cents for primary program, versus 45.6 and 46.3 cents for small shelters and 73.8 and 60.4 cents for large. Across total expenditure, primary program expenditure, and com-

pensation, small and large shelters are statistically indistinguishable from each other, while medium differs significantly from both (all $p < 0.07$).

Table 15: Effects of Government Grants on DV Shelter Expenditure by Shelter Size

		Total Expenditure	Primary Program	Compen- sation	Contract Work	Opera- tions	Occu- pancy	Fund- raising	Other Expenditure
Small	β_1	0.243** (0.103)	0.205** (0.084)	0.147* (0.073)	0.006** (0.003)	-0.007 (0.007)	0.023*** (0.006)	-0.005 (0.006)	0.079** (0.034)
	β_2	0.213 (0.159)	0.258*** (0.062)	0.143 (0.102)	0.005 (0.004)	0.024** (0.009)	0.016 (0.011)	0.005 (0.005)	0.019 (0.066)
	Sum	0.456* (0.248)	0.463*** (0.116)	0.290 (0.168)	0.011** (0.005)	0.017** (0.008)	0.039** (0.014)	0.000 (0.006)	0.099 (0.075)
Medium	β_1	0.659*** (0.060)	0.540*** (0.068)	0.348*** (0.047)	-0.011 (0.018)	0.095** (0.043)	0.012 (0.008)	0.011 (0.012)	0.204** (0.076)
	β_2	0.419*** (0.106)	0.403*** (0.118)	0.274*** (0.055)	0.002 (0.019)	-0.021 (0.039)	0.061* (0.033)	-0.014 (0.015)	0.117* (0.064)
	Sum	1.078*** (0.068)	0.943*** (0.104)	0.622*** (0.069)	-0.009 (0.012)	0.074*** (0.016)	0.073** (0.030)	-0.003 (0.006)	0.321*** (0.100)
Large	β_1	0.564*** (0.109)	0.434*** (0.121)	0.305*** (0.073)	0.094** (0.042)	0.019 (0.032)	-0.030 (0.032)	0.089 (0.078)	0.087 (0.115)
	β_2	0.174*** (0.044)	0.169*** (0.032)	0.060 (0.037)	0.032 (0.071)	-0.004 (0.018)	0.046 (0.032)	-0.014 (0.039)	0.054 (0.081)
	Sum	0.738*** (0.123)	0.604*** (0.124)	0.365*** (0.069)	0.126* (0.063)	0.016 (0.019)	0.016 (0.015)	0.075 (0.055)	0.141 (0.131)

Notes: The table reports the estimated effects of a \$100,000 increase in government grants, separately by baseline shelter size tercile (2013 total revenue). β_1 is the same-year coefficient, β_2 the lagged coefficient, and Sum their combined two-year effect; standard errors in parentheses, with the Sum row's standard error computed via a Wald test. Column definitions match Table 8. All regressions include shelter and year fixed effects, estimated separately within each tercile; standard errors clustered at the shelter level. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

Timing varies by size. For two outcomes, the combined effect is significant across all or most size groups, but timing differs by size. Employee count rises significantly for all three: 0.740 for small, 1.601 for medium, 0.718 for large. Medium's combined effect is significantly larger than small's ($p = 0.008$) and large's ($p = 0.006$). Small shelters' same-year coefficient is significant and their lagged coefficient is not; medium shelters show the reverse; large shelters show neither coefficient individually significant, though the combined effect is.

Operations expenditure shows a similar reversal. Small shelters show a significant combined effect of \$1,719. Medium shelters show a larger combined effect of \$7,411. Large

shelters show no significant effect in either specification. Medium's operations effect is significantly larger than small's ($p = 0.001$) and large's ($p = 0.019$). Small and medium shelters reverse their own timing pattern between employee count and operations: small shelters respond contemporaneously in staffing but with a lag in operations spending, while medium shelters respond with a lag in staffing but contemporaneously in operations spending.

One group only. Volunteer count shows a significant combined effect only for large shelters, a decline of 8.093 volunteers per \$100,000 in grants. Shelters are required to maintain some volunteer involvement regardless of funding, so this reflects a reduction within that constraint rather than a move away from volunteer use entirely. It should also be read cautiously for a data reason: the volunteer regression is estimated on a much smaller sample, since fewer shelters report volunteer counts consistently on Form 990, and this limitation is more severe within the large-shelter subsample specifically.

Table 16: Effects of Government Grants on DV Shelter Staffing by Shelter Size

		Compensation (\$100k)	Contract Work (\$100k)	Employee Count	Volunteer Count	Compensation per Employee (\$100k)
Small	β_1	0.147*	0.006**	0.584**	-0.428	-0.000
		(0.073)	(0.003)	(0.204)	(0.811)	(0.003)
	β_2	0.143	0.005	0.155	-0.163	0.002
		(0.102)	(0.004)	(0.270)	(1.250)	(0.005)
	Sum	0.290	0.011**	0.740**	-0.591	0.002
		(0.168)	(0.005)	(0.275)	(1.015)	(0.007)
Medium	β_1	0.348***	-0.011	0.147	-1.028	0.015
		(0.047)	(0.018)	(0.350)	(4.821)	(0.009)
	β_2	0.274***	0.002	1.454***	-0.690	-0.008
		(0.055)	(0.019)	(0.369)	(3.884)	(0.007)
	Sum	0.622***	-0.009	1.601***	-1.719	0.006*
		(0.069)	(0.012)	(0.177)	(5.849)	(0.003)
Large	β_1	0.305***	0.094**	0.300	-9.274*	0.004**
		(0.073)	(0.042)	(0.280)	(4.702)	(0.001)
	β_2	0.060	0.032	0.417	1.180	-0.001
		(0.037)	(0.071)	(0.272)	(2.624)	(0.002)
	Sum	0.365***	0.126*	0.718**	-8.093*	0.004
		(0.069)	(0.063)	(0.271)	(3.991)	(0.002)

Notes: The table reports the estimated effects of a \$100,000 increase in government grants, separately by baseline shelter size tercile (2013 total revenue). β_1 is the same-year coefficient, β_2 the lagged coefficient, and Sum their combined two-year effect; standard errors in parentheses, with the Sum row's standard error computed via a Wald test. Column definitions match Table 9. All regressions include shelter and year fixed effects, estimated separately within each tercile; standard errors clustered at the shelter level. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

Homicides, Discharges, and Child Maltreatment

For IPV and DV hospital discharge rates and homicide rates, the estimated effect differs in sign across terciles, but no pairwise difference between terciles is statistically significant in any comparison.

Table 17: Effects of Government Grants on Hospital Discharges by Shelter Size

		IPV Discharge	DV Discharge	Assault Discharge
		Rate per 100k	Rate per 100k	Rate per 100k
		Total County Population		Female Pop. 18–34
Small	β_1	-0.490*	-0.577	-5.911
		(0.237)	(0.394)	(6.744)
	β_2	0.264	0.472	23.177**
		(0.357)	(0.598)	(9.903)
	Sum	-0.226	-0.106	17.266
		(0.410)	(0.733)	(10.746)
Medium	β_1	-0.309**	-0.415	5.779
		(0.133)	(0.550)	(7.086)
	β_2	0.088	0.366	23.131**
		(0.309)	(0.754)	(9.875)
	Sum	-0.221	-0.049	28.910**
		(0.324)	(1.182)	(13.101)
Large	β_1	0.435*	0.390	-0.735
		(0.228)	(0.316)	(4.315)
	β_2	-0.381*	-0.295	2.015
		(0.212)	(0.360)	(4.377)
	Sum	0.055	0.095	1.280
		(0.144)	(0.224)	(3.299)

Notes: The table reports the estimated effects of a \$100,000 increase in government grants on county-level hospital discharge rates, separately by baseline shelter size tercile. Shelter grant funding is aggregated to the county level. β_1 is the same-year coefficient, β_2 the lagged coefficient, and Sum their combined two-year effect; standard errors in parentheses, with the Sum row's standard error computed via a Wald test. Column definitions match Table 10. All regressions include county and year fixed effects, estimated separately within each tercile; standard errors clustered at the county level. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

Table 18: Effects of Government Grants on DV Homicides by Shelter Size

		IPV Homicide	DV Homicide	Female Homicide	Child Homicide
		Total County Population		Female Pop. 18-34	Pop. Under 18
Small	β_1	-0.057	0.250**	-1.414**	-0.044
		(0.046)	(0.111)	(0.550)	(0.104)
	β_2	0.251*	-0.047	-0.459	-0.030
		(0.142)	(0.113)	(0.800)	(0.206)
	Sum	0.194	0.203	-1.874*	-0.074
		(0.116)	(0.127)	(0.920)	(0.147)
Medium	β_1	-0.170***	-0.216***	0.135	0.032
		(0.050)	(0.068)	(0.191)	(0.148)
	β_2	0.162**	0.220**	-0.235	0.041
		(0.059)	(0.075)	(0.235)	(0.176)
	Sum	-0.007	0.003	-0.100	0.073
		(0.053)	(0.064)	(0.189)	(0.240)
Large	β_1	0.018	0.053	-0.058	-0.047
		(0.026)	(0.033)	(0.069)	(0.132)
	β_2	-0.007	-0.041	0.216*	-0.034
		(0.021)	(0.026)	(0.117)	(0.143)
	Sum	0.012	0.011	0.158**	-0.080
		(0.011)	(0.019)	(0.064)	(0.118)

Notes: The table reports the estimated effects of a \$100,000 increase in government grants on county-level homicide rates, separately by baseline shelter size tercile. Shelter grant funding is aggregated to the county level. β_1 is the same-year coefficient, β_2 the lagged coefficient, and Sum their combined two-year effect; standard errors in parentheses, with the Sum row's standard error computed via a Wald test. Column definitions match Table 11. All regressions include county and year fixed effects, estimated separately within each tercile; standard errors clustered at the county level. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

The combined effect is not significant for any NCANDS outcome in any tercile, with one exception: medium shelters show a marginally significant decline in substantiated reports for children ages 11–18 (−13.49 per 100,000, $p = 0.073$), also marginally different from large shelters' effect ($p = 0.089$). Child homicide shows no significant combined effect, and no significant pairwise difference, in any tercile.

Table 19: Effects of Government Grants on Child Maltreatment Reports by Shelter Size

		All Ages	Infant	Ages 1–3	Ages 4–10	Ages 11–18	DV Risk	Foster
		Rate per 100k Population Under 18						
Small	β_1	-4.816	-1.423	-1.991	2.430	-3.831	-7.162	0.340
		(10.393)	(3.016)	(1.859)	(5.554)	(2.892)	(4.601)	(2.694)
	β_2	26.670	-2.741	10.390	8.233	10.790	14.180	4.197
		(48.959)	(7.437)	(8.402)	(20.841)	(12.867)	(15.817)	(7.236)
	Sum	21.860	-4.165	8.399	10.660	6.960	7.018	4.537
		(54.785)	(9.544)	(9.385)	(21.745)	(14.748)	(16.939)	(6.132)
Medium	β_1	-21.850	-0.487	-2.965	-8.545	-9.856**	-5.755	-3.581
		(15.657)	(2.505)	(3.754)	(6.831)	(4.402)	(4.399)	(3.920)
	β_2	-6.271	1.563	-2.332	-1.869	-3.632	1.662	1.587
		(18.105)	(2.563)	(3.579)	(8.542)	(4.624)	(5.777)	(4.039)
	Sum	-28.120	1.076	-5.297	-10.410	-13.490*	-4.093	-1.994
		(23.708)	(3.276)	(4.692)	(10.544)	(6.946)	(5.326)	(5.370)
Large	β_1	-13.600	-1.902	-2.496	-6.167	-3.030	0.958	0.374
		(12.436)	(1.185)	(2.763)	(6.062)	(3.106)	(5.810)	(3.835)
	β_2	13.840	1.370	2.331	7.926	2.218	0.617	-2.592
		(11.217)	(1.075)	(2.417)	(5.474)	(3.207)	(7.219)	(2.822)
	Sum	0.249	-0.532	-0.165	1.758	-0.812	1.575	-2.218
		(10.409)	(0.919)	(2.103)	(5.103)	(2.693)	(3.123)	(2.032)

Notes: The table reports the estimated effects of a \$100,000 increase in government grants on county-level substantiated child maltreatment report rates, separately by baseline shelter size tercile. Shelter grant funding is aggregated to the county level. β_1 is the same-year coefficient, β_2 the lagged coefficient, and Sum their combined two-year effect; standard errors in parentheses, with the Sum row's standard error computed via a Wald test. Column definitions match Table 12. All regressions include county and year fixed effects, estimated separately within each tercile; standard errors clustered at the county level. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

7 Robustness

This section presents two checks on the main specification: a leave-one-out analysis that re-estimates the model after dropping each shelter individually, and a subsample restricted to shelters with December fiscal year ends. Together, these checks assess whether the main results are driven by a small number of influential shelters or by the rule assigning Form 990 filings to federal award years. Additional robustness checks, including a pre-2020 subsample, a specification with time-varying county controls, and an Oster bounding exercise, are reported in Appendix G.

Table 20 reports leave-one-out results for β_1 , β_2 , and their combined two-year sum, re-estimating the specification after dropping each of the 46 shelters one at a time and recording the median, minimum, and maximum coefficient across the 46 reruns. For most outcomes, the median leave-one-out estimate is close to the main estimate across β_1 , β_2 , and the sum, with a narrow range across reruns: no single shelter drives the results.

Table 20: Robustness: Leave-One-Out (46 Samples)

		Main	Median	Min	Max
Total Revenue	β_1	61,900***	61,661	57,167	71,976
	β_2	37,767**	38,001	24,226	41,972
	Sum	99,700***	99,559	94,370	104,877
Total Expenditure	β_1	57,300***	57,222	52,715	60,264
	β_2	25,231***	25,206	23,145	28,917
	Sum	82,525***	82,431	76,920	87,364
Compensation	β_1	31,563***	31,546	28,309	33,408
	β_2	11,570***	11,538	10,191	13,694
	Sum	43,132***	43,081	39,532	45,945
Occupancy	β_1	−900	−963	−1,581	1,125
	β_2	4,000*	4,021	2,222	4,598
	Sum	3,070***	3,059	2,566	3,606
Employee Count	β_1	0.411*	0.377	0.271	0.441
	β_2	0.503**	0.493	0.397	0.600
	Sum	0.913***	0.873	0.784	0.930
Private Donations	β_1	−38,900**	−39,151	−43,500	−28,152
	β_2	39,683**	39,915	26,028	44,080
	Sum	771	704	−4,742	5,119

Notes: The table reports the main estimate alongside the median, minimum, and maximum coefficient obtained by re-estimating the specification after dropping each of the 46 shelters one at a time. β_1 is the same-year coefficient, β_2 the lagged coefficient, and Sum their combined two-year effect. All specifications include shelter and year fixed effects with standard errors clustered at the shelter level. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

Table 21 restricts the sample to the 24 shelters with December fiscal year ends, the largest single fiscal-year group in the panel, to assess whether the rule assigning Form 990

filings to federal award years introduces measurement error for shelters with non-December fiscal years. Estimated effects on total revenue, total expenditure, compensation, and employee count remain significant in the December FY subsample under both the same-year and combined two-year specifications, directionally consistent with the full-sample results.

The combined two-year effect on private donations is not statistically significant in either sample (\$771 full sample, $-\$4,333$ December FY), a precise null in both cases that corroborates rather than contradicts the full-sample finding. The same-year coefficient on private donations, by contrast, is significant in the full sample but not in the December FY subsample.

This same pattern—significant in the full sample, insignificant in the smaller December FY subsample—also appears in the lagged coefficient for total revenue, compensation, and private donations, consistent with the subsample restriction reducing precision on the lagged coefficient given the smaller sample size, rather than a systematic difference in how December FY shelters respond to grants over time. For total expenditure and employee count, the lagged coefficient remains significant in the December FY subsample despite the smaller sample. The combined two-year effect remains significant for revenue and compensation regardless, since the same-year coefficient is larger in the December FY subsample.

Table 21: Robustness: December Fiscal Year Subsample

		Full Sample	December FY Only
Total Revenue	β_1	61,900***	86,741***
		(14,733)	(17,912)
	β_2	37,767**	9,040
		(15,832)	(7,420)
	Sum	99,700***	95,781***
		(9,796)	(14,696)
Total Expenditure	β_1	57,300***	63,646***
		(6,890)	(9,329)
	β_2	25,231***	21,179***
		(5,084)	(3,886)
	Sum	82,525***	84,824***
		(8,446)	(10,185)
Compensation	β_1	31,563***	35,503***
		(4,973)	(6,622)
	β_2	11,570***	9,626
		(3,863)	(7,153)
	Sum	43,132***	45,129***
		(5,694)	(11,169)
Employee Count	β_1	0.411**	0.621**
		(0.207)	(0.251)
	β_2	0.503**	0.574***
		(0.211)	(0.177)
	Sum	0.913***	1.194***
		(0.200)	(0.240)
Private Donations	β_1	-38,900**	-8,576
		(16,097)	(13,219)
	β_2	39,683**	4,243
		(16,996)	(7,286)
	Sum	771	-4,333
		(9,126)	(13,073)

Notes: The table reports the same-year coefficient (β_1), lagged coefficient (β_2), and combined two-year effect (Sum) for the full sample and for the subsample of 24 shelters with December fiscal year ends. Standard errors in parentheses. All specifications include shelter and year fixed effects with standard errors clustered at the shelter level. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

8 Conclusion

Policymakers allocating federal resources to domestic violence shelter programs have lacked an empirical basis for evaluating the funding’s effects. This paper offers the first such evidence, using a novel panel of Georgia DV shelters linked to county-level outcomes.

A \$100,000 increase in government grants raises shelter revenue by \$61,900 in the same year and \$99,700 across both years. The combined two-year effect on private donations is not statistically distinguishable from zero, in contrast to the 70 to 75 cents per dollar of crowd-out documented elsewhere in the nonprofit literature; this pooled result is not uniform across shelter sizes, however, since the combined two-year effect on private donations is a significant decline for small shelters but not for medium or large shelters. Total expenditure rises by \$57,300 in the same year and \$82,500 across both years, directed primarily toward compensation and program services, and employee counts rise by 0.411 in the same year and 0.913 across both years. These combined two-year effects on revenue, expenditure, compensation, and employee count are similar in magnitude across leave-one-out samples and a subsample restricted to December fiscal-year shelters. The lagged coefficients indicate that shelters spend a meaningful share of grant dollars in the fiscal year following receipt.

Estimated effects on community-level violence and child maltreatment are small and do not survive correction for multiple hypothesis testing. The heterogeneity analysis shows a significant combined two-year increase in female assault hospital discharges for medium shelters, but this pattern does not extend to homicides, child maltreatment, or small and large shelters. Taken together, these results do not point clearly toward any single channel through which shelter funding could affect community-level violence.

A minimal aggregate effect on incidence is still consistent with funding benefiting DV victims. Funding may improve the quality of services provided to victims already in contact with a shelter without expanding the number of victims served or reached; county-level incidence data cannot detect a pure quality effect. A victim who receives more intensive safety planning or advocacy, but whose decision to leave or whose contact with law enforcement

or hospitals does not change, would not appear as a change in aggregate violence counts. Evaluating whether funding improves outcomes for victims already receiving services would require individual-level data on service recipients that does not exist in any of the sources used in this paper.

DV shelters are the primary resource available to victims outside the criminal justice system. This paper establishes that government grants increase shelter revenue, expenditure, and staffing, with limited evidence of crowd-out except for small shelters, where the combined two-year effect on private donations is a significant decline. Estimated effects on community-level violence and child maltreatment are small and sensitive to specification, providing limited evidence that funding reduces the incidence of DV or child maltreatment at the county level. Whether funding nonetheless improves conditions for the victims a shelter directly serves is a question this paper's data cannot answer. The violence results are consistent both with funding having little effect on victims already in contact with services, and with a true improvement offset by increased help-seeking. This paper provides the data infrastructure and empirical foundation for future work on the impact of DV shelter resources for victims of abuse.

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A Data Appendix

This appendix provides supporting detail on the construction of the DV Shelter Database described in Section 3: the search terms used to identify candidate shelters, and the Form 990 variables extracted for each shelter-year. This section also outlines the range of services Georgia shelters provide, as recorded in the CJCC administrative data introduced in Section 4.2.

A.1 DV Search Terms

The following terms were used to flag potential DV service providers in the first stage of shelter identification. Terms were derived from a review of Form 990 filings from shelters identified through an independent online search, and were selected to capture the range of terminology used by organizations to describe domestic violence programming.

Table 22: Search Terms Used for DV Shelter Identification

<i>Search Terms</i>	
domestic violence	intimate partner abuse
domestic abuse	battered women
intimate partner violence	domestic assault
family violence	family abuse
spousal abuse	spouse abuse
dating violence	DV
relationship violence	IPV

A.2 DV Shelter Database Variables

Table 23 reports the Form 990 variables extracted for each shelter-year in the DV Shelter Database, described in Section 3.1. Table 24 reports the revenue and expenditure variables

constructed from these raw entries.

Table 23: IRS 990 Database Variable Identification

Database Variable	Level	990 Entry and Instruction
Organization Name	Organization	Name of organization
Address	Organization	City or town, state or province, country, and ZIP
EIN	Organization	Employer Identification Number
Employee Count	Organization	Total number of individuals employed in calendar year
Volunteer Count	Organization	Total number of volunteers (estimate if necessary)
Mission Statement	Organization	Briefly describe the organization's mission
Tax Year Start	Organization	Tax year beginning on Month - Day - Year
Tax Year End	Organization	Tax year ending on Month - Day - Year
Total Revenue	Organization	Total revenue
Total Expenditure	Organization	Total expenses
Total Compensation	Organization	Salaries, other compensation, employee benefits
Program Description‡	Program	Describe the organization's program service accomplishments of each of its three largest program services, as measured by expenses
Program Expenditure‡	Program	Report the total expenses for each program service
Officers, Directors, Trustees, Key Employees		
Employee Name§	Organization	Name
Employee Title§	Organization	Title
Employee Compensation§	Organization	Reportable compensation from the organization
Statement of Revenue (Organization Level)		
Program Revenue	Organization	Program Revenue
Federated Campaigns Revenue	Organization	Federated Campaigns
Membership Dues Revenue	Organization	Membership Dues
Related Organizations Revenue	Organization	Related Organizations
Fundraising Events Revenue	Organization	Fundraising Event
Government Grants Revenue	Organization	Government Grants
All Other Contributions	Organization	All other contributions, gifts, grants, and similar amounts not included above
Statement of Functional Expenses (Organization Level)		
Fundraising Expenditure	Organization	Total fundraising expenses
Occupancy Expenditure	Organization	Facilities expenses including rent, utilities, property insurance, real estate taxes, and mortgage interest
Legal Expenditure	Organization	Legal fees for services (non-employees)
Accounting Expenditure	Organization	Accounting fees for services (non-employees)
Management Fee Expenditure	Organization	Management fees for services (non-employees)
Lobbying Expenditure	Organization	Lobbying fees for services (non-employees)
Other Fee-for-Service	Organization	Any other fees for services (non-employees)
Advertising Expenditure	Organization	Advertising and promotion costs
Office Expenditure	Organization	Office supplies, equipment, and postage
Travel Expenditure	Organization	Travel and transportation costs
Conference Expenditure	Organization	Conferences, conventions, and meetings
Employee Benefits Expenditure	Organization	Employee benefits (not including pension plan contributions)
Payroll Taxes Expenditure	Organization	Payroll taxes
IT Expenditure	Organization	Information Technology expenses
Interest	Organization	Total interest expenses
Depreciation	Organization	Depreciation, depletion, and amortization

Notes: The table describes the variables in the DV Shelter Database and their respective 990 form entry descriptions. Organization-level variables are reported once per organization per year. ‡ Program-level variables are reported up to three times per organization per year, once for each of the organization's three largest program services by expense. § These organization-level variables are reported up to seventeen times per organization per year, once for each officer, director, trustee, or key employee.

Table 24: Constructed Revenue and Expenditure Variables

Variable	Construction
Expenditure	
Fee-for-Service Expenditure	Sum of management, legal, accounting, lobbying, fundraising, and other fee-for-service expenditures
Operations Expenditure	Sum of advertising, office, information technology, travel, and conference expenditures
Other Expenditure	Total expenditure minus compensation, fee-for-service expenditure, operations expenditure, occupancy expenditure, and fundraising expenditure
Revenue	
Private Donations	Sum of all other contributions and fundraising event revenue
Private Donation Share	Private donations divided by total revenue
Other Revenue	Total revenue minus government grants, private donations, and program service revenue
Other Revenue Share	Other revenue divided by total revenue
Program Revenue Share	Program service revenue divided by total revenue

Notes: This table describes revenue and expenditure variables constructed from the raw IRS Form 990 entries listed in Table 23. Fee-for-service, operations, and other expenditure categories are constructed to be mutually exclusive and collectively exhaustive of total expenditure. Private donations, other revenue, and program service revenue are constructed to be mutually exclusive and collectively exhaustive of total revenue, alongside government grants.

A.3 Georgia Shelter Service Provision

Table 25 reports the full 39-service breakdown underlying the descriptive characterization of Georgia’s DV shelter landscape in Section 4.2.

Table 25: Full Service Provision Breakdown, 2018–2022

Service	Shelter-Yr (%)	Ever (%)	Always (%)	Mean Victims/Yr
TANF/Government Benefits Assistance	87.4	100.0	63.0	110
Criminal Justice Support/Advocacy	90.4	100.0	69.6	327
Crisis Coordination	87.0	100.0	60.9	2,581
Crisis Line	99.1	100.0	95.7	2,017
Emergency Financial Assistance	91.3	100.0	69.6	178
Emergency Legal Assistance	90.4	100.0	73.9	801
Individual Support	99.1	100.0	95.7	7,599
Interagency Advocacy	90.9	100.0	76.1	823
Non-Emergency Legal Assistance	92.2	100.0	73.9	523
Referral to Services, Support, Resources	99.1	100.0	95.7	1,107
Relocation Assistance	90.0	100.0	67.4	210
Safe Housing	97.8	100.0	91.3	3,684
Support Group	93.9	100.0	84.8	617
Transportation Assistance	98.7	100.0	93.5	1,297
Child/Dependent Care Assistance	82.6	97.8	56.5	259
Information on Criminal Justice Process	72.2	97.8	41.3	170
Provide Info Explaining Victim Rights	76.5	95.7	45.7	186
Assistance Applying for Victims Compensation	73.9	95.7	45.7	40
Provide Access to Language Assistance	63.5	95.7	34.8	78
Advocacy/Accompaniment–Emergency Medical	60.9	93.5	28.3	43
Non-Traditional Therapeutic Intervention	66.5	93.5	39.1	340
Therapy from Licensed Clinician/Counselor	65.7	93.5	39.1	200
Civil Legal Attorney Assistance–TPO	65.2	87.0	30.4	96
Assistance Placing Animals in Distress	55.2	82.6	21.7	30
Law Enforcement Interview Advocacy	42.6	78.3	15.2	30
Civil Legal Attorney Assistance–Family Law	38.3	71.7	6.5	47
Transitional Housing	39.1	71.7	17.4	1,147
Immigration Assistance–Advocate	33.0	69.6	10.9	27
Victim Notification of Criminal Justice Events	33.5	67.4	8.7	46
Group Therapy	24.8	58.7	4.3	62
Victim Impact Assistance	16.5	47.8	2.2	22
Assistance with Restitution	7.8	28.3	0.0	0.75
Prosecution Interview Advocacy	13.9	32.6	2.2	12.4
On-Scene Crisis Response	15.7	34.8	2.2	4.9
Performance of Initial Forensic Medical Exam	13.0	19.6	8.7	9.4
Performance of Forensic Interview	13.9	17.4	8.7	8.8
Performance of Follow-Up Forensic Medical Exam	10.9	17.4	2.2	0.67
Immigration Assistance–Attorney	5.2	13.0	0.0	6.9

Notes: Sample includes 46 shelters with CJCC service records, 2018–2022 ($N = 230$ shelter-years unless otherwise noted). Shelter-Yr is the shelter-year average offering rate. Ever is the share of the 46 shelters offering the service in at least one sample year. Always is the share offering it in every year observed. Mean victims/year is the shelter-year average. Sorted by Ever (descending) within the near-universal/non-near-universal groupings implied in Table 4. Excludes “Other Service Provided,” which no shelter reports offering. Data come from CJCC utilization reports.

B Full Event Study Results

This appendix reports event study estimates, following equation (2), for every outcome examined in the main text. Section 5.2 presents four representative panels (total revenue, total expenditure, female homicides, and female assault discharges) as evidence on pre-trends; this appendix reports the full set of outcomes from Tables 7–12 for completeness. Each panel plots the coefficient and 95 percent confidence interval on the interaction between the initial shelter grant change and year indicators, with the same specification and sample period as the corresponding main-text table.

B.1 Revenue

Figures 5 and 6 report event study estimates for the revenue outcomes in Table 7.

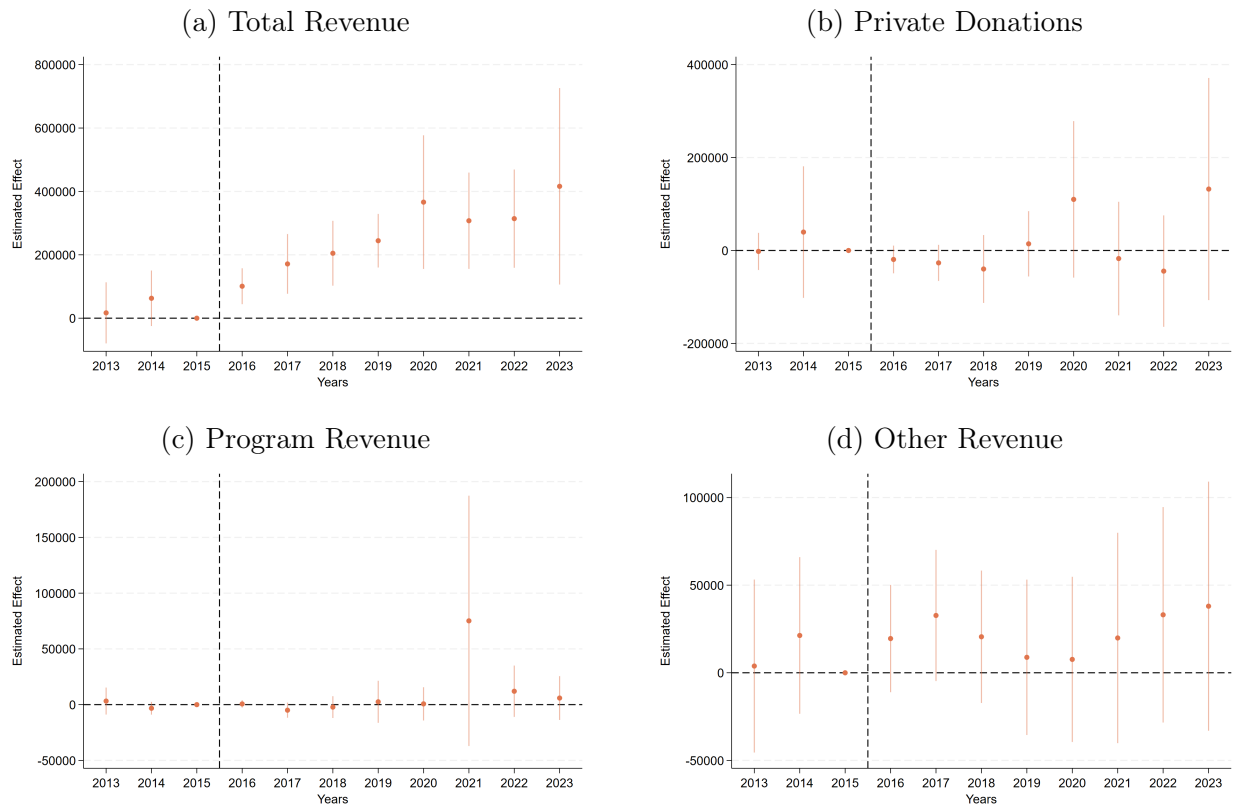


Figure 5: Event Study Estimates: Revenue Outcomes (1 of 2)



Figure 6: Event Study Estimates: Revenue Outcomes (2 of 2)

B.2 Expenditure

Figure 7 reports event study estimates for the expenditure outcomes in Table 8.

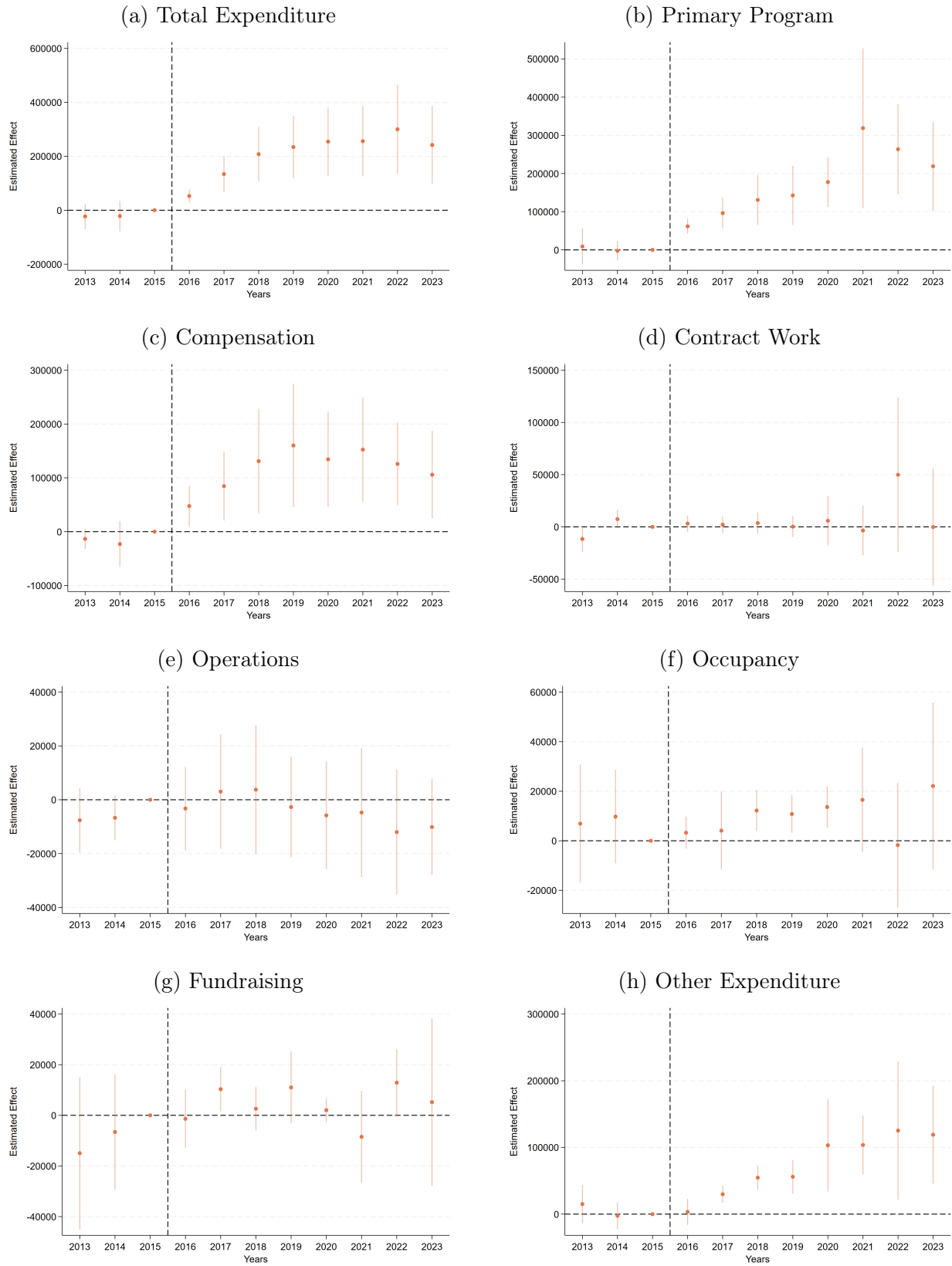


Figure 7: Event Study Estimates: Expenditure Outcomes

B.3 Staffing

Figure 8 reports event study estimates for the staffing outcomes in Table 9.

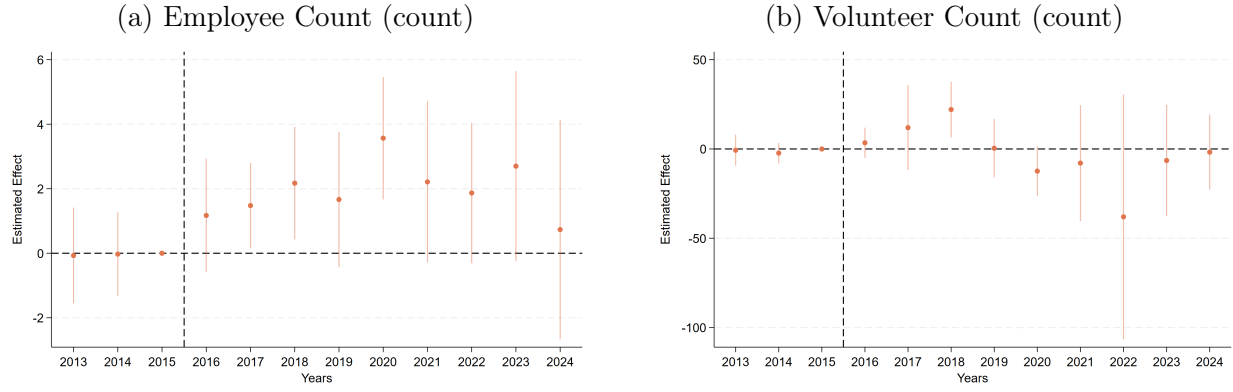
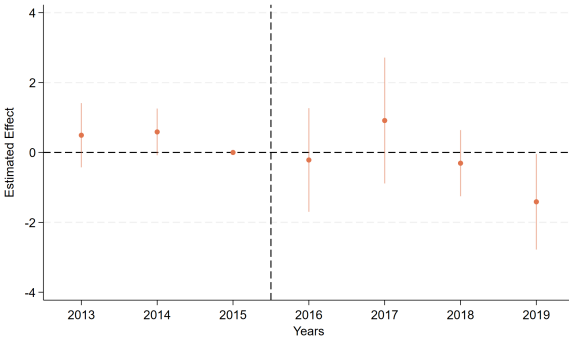


Figure 8: Event Study Estimates: Staffing Outcomes

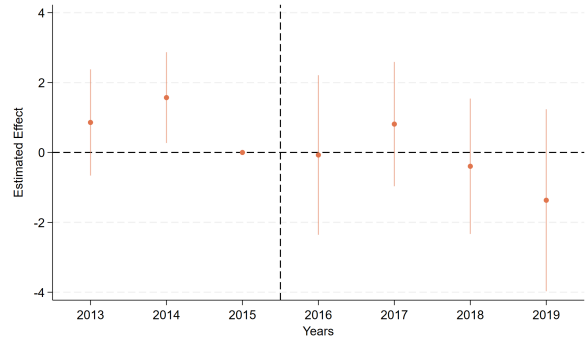
B.4 HCUP

Figure 9 reports event study estimates for the HCUP outcomes in Table 10.

(a) IPV Discharge (per 100,000 total county population)



(b) DV Discharge (per 100,000 total county population)



(c) Assault Discharge (per 100,000 females 18–34)

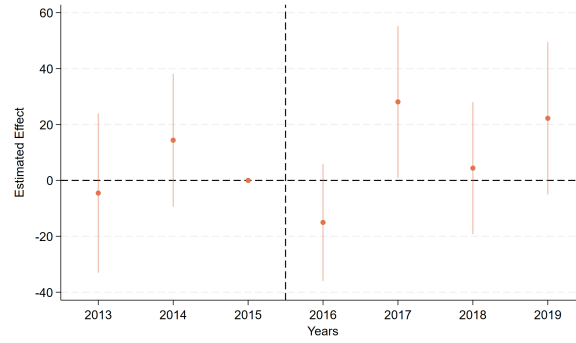
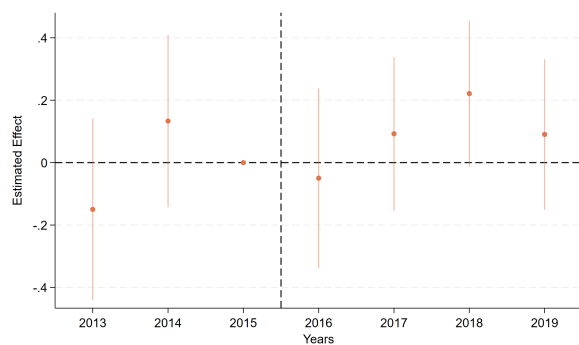


Figure 9: Event Study Estimates: HCUP Outcomes

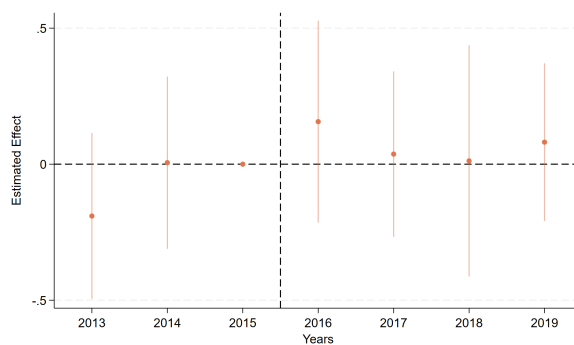
B.5 Homicides

Figure 10 reports event study estimates for the homicide outcomes in Table 11.

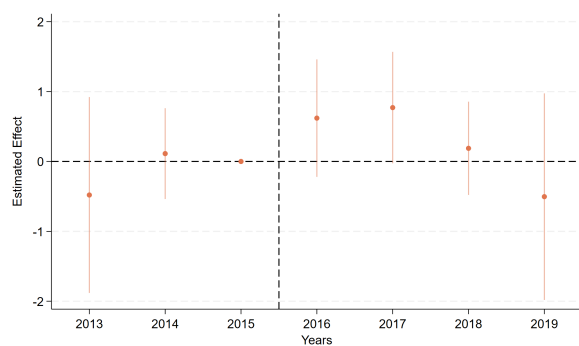
(a) IPV Homicide (per 100,000 total county population)



(b) DV Homicide (per 100,000 total county population)



(c) Female Homicide (per 100,000 females 18–34)



(d) Child Homicide (per 100,000 population under 18)

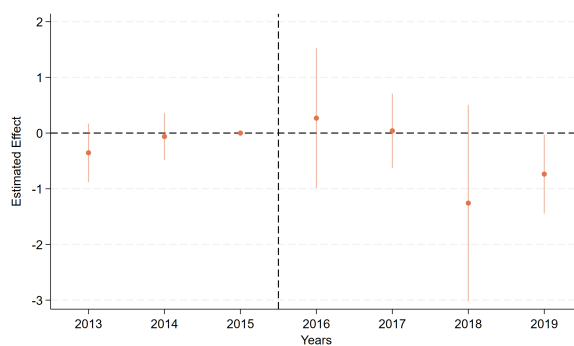


Figure 10: Event Study Estimates: Homicides Outcomes

B.6 NCANDS

Figure 11 reports event study estimates for the NCANDS outcomes in Table 12.

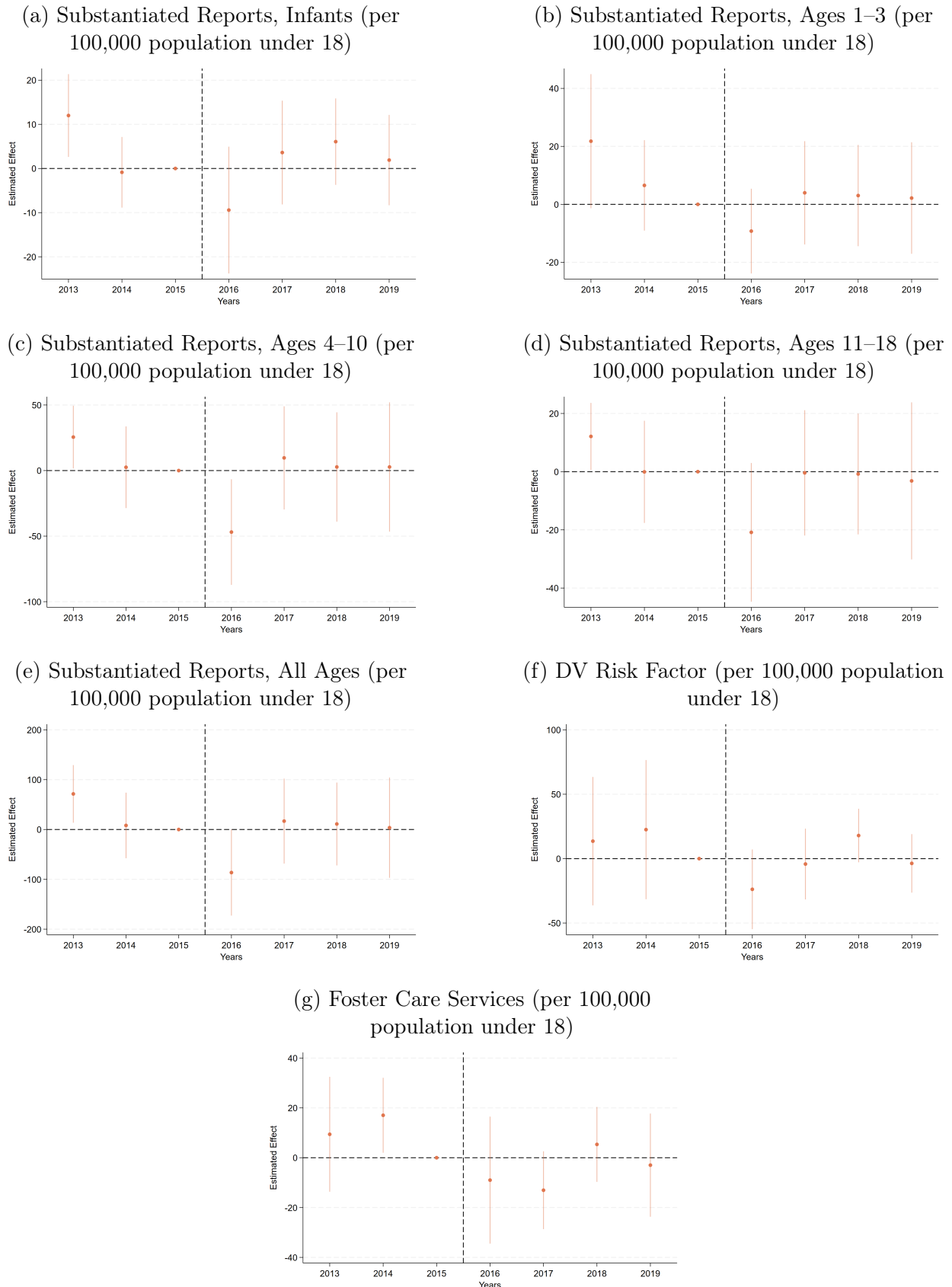


Figure 11: Event Study Estimates: NCANDS Outcomes

C Characterizing the Grant Allocation Process

This appendix characterizes how government grant funding was allocated across shelters and over time, supporting the parallel trends discussion in Section 5.2. Section C.1 characterizes funding persistence within shelters and whether the 2015 funding expansion scaled up existing allocations or redirected funding across shelters. Sections C.2 and C.3 test whether grant levels and grant changes are predictable from observable shelter and county characteristics, including prior changes in the outcomes examined in Section 6. Section C.4 tests whether a shelter’s pre-2015 funding position predicts its subsequent funding growth.

C.1 Funding Persistence and Structure

This characterization supports the claim in Section 5.2 that grant funding varies primarily across shelters rather than through common year-to-year shocks, which underlies the paper’s identification strategy.

I estimate the persistence of grant funding using $G_{it} = \alpha_i + \gamma_t + \rho G_{i,t-1} + \varepsilon_{it}$ over 2014–2023. The estimated persistence coefficient is $\hat{\rho} = 0.745$ ($p < 0.001$): a shelter’s grant funding in one year strongly predicts its funding the following year, rather than fluctuating independently.

Table 26 reports quintile transition matrices comparing each shelter’s grant funding quintile in 2013 to its quintile in 2016, 2019, and 2023. Shelters at the extremes of the funding distribution retain their rank at high rates: shelters in the bottom quintile in 2013 remain there in 62–78 percent of subsequent years, and top-quintile shelters remain there in 63–88 percent. Middle-quintile shelters transition more frequently, with no middle-quintile cell exceeding 44 percent retention in any period. Funding rank is therefore most stable at the extremes and least stable among moderately funded shelters.

I use Figure 12 and Table 27 to assess whether the 2015 CVF expansion scaled up existing allocations or reallocated funding toward previously low-funded shelters, regressing

Table 26: Grant Funding Quintile Transition Matrices

2013 quintile	2016 quintile					2019 quintile					2023 quintile				
	1	2	3	4	5	1	2	3	4	5	1	2	3	4	5
1	66.7	22.2	0.0	11.1	0.0	77.8	11.1	0.0	0.0	11.1	66.7	22.2	0.0	0.0	11.1
2	33.3	33.3	33.3	0.0	0.0	22.2	55.6	11.1	11.1	0.0	22.2	44.4	22.2	11.1	0.0
3	0.0	33.3	33.3	33.3	0.0	0.0	25.0	37.5	25.0	12.5	22.2	22.2	22.2	11.1	22.2
4	0.0	11.1	22.2	44.4	22.2	0.0	11.1	33.3	33.3	22.2	0.0	11.1	44.4	33.3	11.1
5	0.0	0.0	0.0	12.5	87.5	0.0	0.0	25.0	12.5	62.5	0.0	0.0	12.5	25.0	62.5

Cell entries are row percentages: the share of shelters in a given 2013 quintile that fall into each quintile in the comparison year. Quintile 1 is the lowest grant funding; quintile 5 is the highest.

grant funding in 2016, 2018, 2019, and 2023 on 2013 grant funding. The fitted slope is close to or above 1 in each year: 0.808 in 2016, 1.059 in 2018, 0.960 in 2019, and 1.342 in 2023. A shelter's 2013 funding rank therefore predicts its funding rank closely through 2019; by 2023, shelters with larger 2013 baseline funding received disproportionately larger increases. This pattern is consistent with the funding expansion scaling up existing allocations rather than redirecting funding toward shelters that received less at baseline.

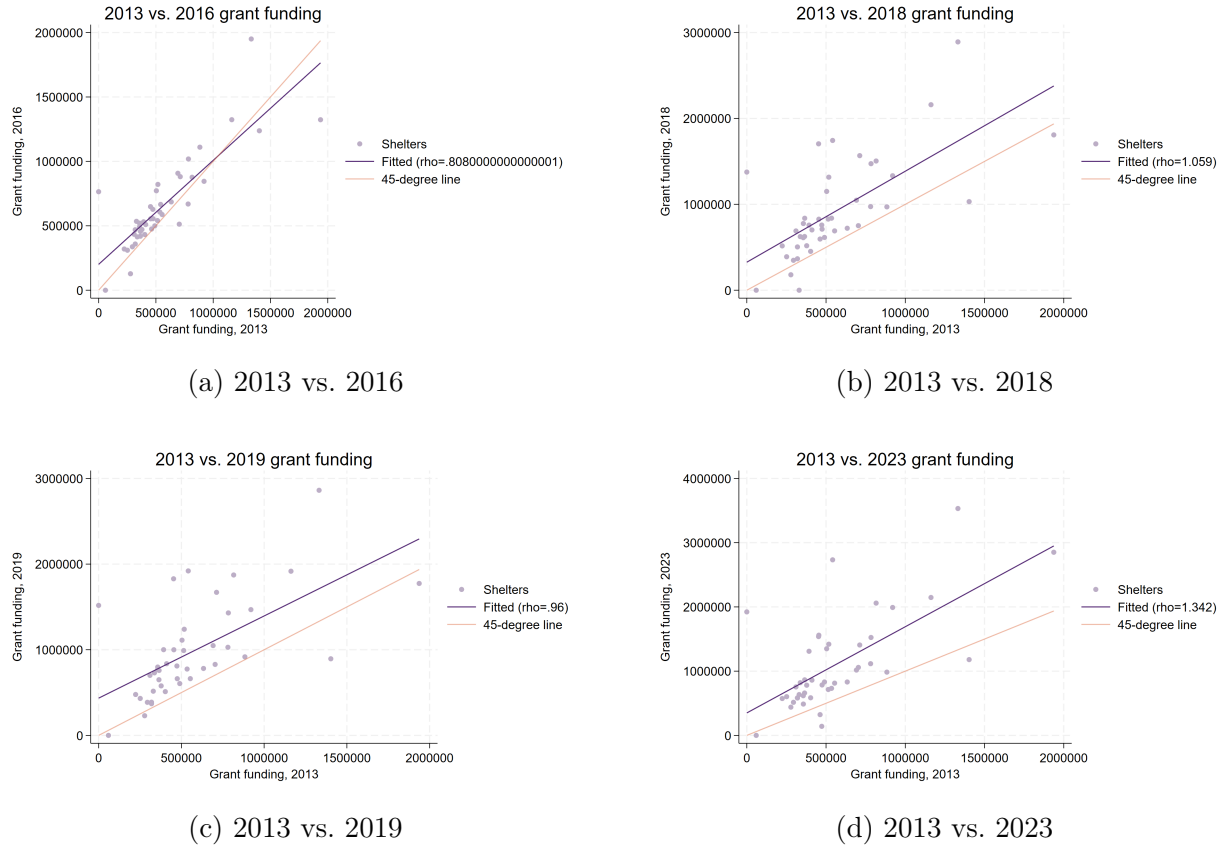


Figure 12: Grant Funding in Later Years versus 2013 Baseline Funding

Table 27: Fitted Slopes of Grant Funding on 2013 Baseline Funding

Year	$\hat{\rho}$
2016	0.808
2018	1.059
2019	0.960
2023	1.342

Slope from $G_{it} = \alpha + \rho G_{i,2013} + \varepsilon_{it}$, estimated separately by year.

C.2 The Annual Grant Allocation Equation

This exercise tests whether observable shelter or county characteristics predict CJCC funding decisions. If they do, funding may respond to conditions correlated with the outcomes I study, violating the parallel trends assumption. I distinguish grant-level predictability from grant-change predictability: lagged revenue and expenditure predicting a shelter’s current grant level is expected under a purely mechanical accounting relationship, since grant funding is itself a component of revenue, and is therefore uninformative about whether CJCC responds to shelter need. Predictability of grant *changes*, by contrast, would indicate that the timing and size of funding adjustments respond to observable conditions rather than reflecting a process largely disconnected from year-to-year shelter or county characteristics.

I estimate $G_{it} = \alpha_i + \gamma_t + X'_{i,t-1}\beta + \varepsilon_{it}$ using the 2014–2023 panel, where $X_{i,t-1}$ includes lagged shelter finances, county violence, county demographics, and shelter staffing, grouped into conceptually meaningful blocks. Table 28 reports results by block, a combined specification including all blocks, and a first-differenced specification using the annual grant change as the outcome.

Among the four blocks, the finance block is the most predictive ($F = 118.71$, $p < 0.001$, within $R^2 = 0.643$), the expected result given the mechanical link between grants, revenue, and expenditure described above. The staffing block is also jointly significant ($F = 5.80$, $p = 0.007$), with employee count individually predictive. County demographics are jointly significant ($F = 4.59$, $p = 0.002$) though they explain little variation (within $R^2 = 0.126$), driven primarily by county birth counts. County violence variables are not jointly significant predictors of grant funding. In the fully saturated combined specification, the coefficient on lagged grant funding falls to 0.141 and loses significance ($p = 0.586$), reflecting collinearity between grant funding, revenue, and expenditure.

The first-differenced specification is the more informative test, since it is not subject to the mechanical relationship described above. None of the lagged shelter finance, county violence, or county demographic variables predicts the size of a shelter’s grant change; within

R^2 falls to 0.151. Grant levels are therefore predictable largely because of the mechanical link between grants and revenue, but grant changes—the funding decisions CJCC actually makes each year—are not predicted by any observable measure tested here, a pattern inconsistent with an allocation process that adjusts funding annually in response to observable shelter or county need.

C.3 Do Prior Outcome Changes Predict Future Grant Changes?

This test addresses reverse causality directly. If CJCC increases funding in response to deteriorating shelter conditions or worsening county violence, or reduces funding as conditions improve, grant changes would be endogenous to the outcomes I study, confounding the estimated effects of grants on those outcomes. A positive relationship between a prior change in an outcome and the following year’s grant change would be consistent with this kind of reactive allocation, though it would not establish reactive allocation on its own, since factors unrelated to CJCC decisions could drive both a shelter’s organizational trajectory and its future funding. I estimate $\Delta G_{it} = \gamma_t + \beta \Delta Y_{i,t-1} + \alpha_i + \varepsilon_{it}$ for twelve outcomes spanning shelter finances, staffing, community violence, and child maltreatment.

Table 29 reports these results. Two coefficients are significant at conventional levels: a prior increase in the female homicide rate predicts a smaller next-period grant change ($\hat{\beta} = -1,791.4$, $p = 0.018$), and a prior increase in the DV homicide rate is marginally significant ($\hat{\beta} = -8,639.6$, $p = 0.052$). Both are negative—the opposite of what a reactive, needs-based allocation process would predict, under which a worsening homicide rate would predict a larger grant change. Applying a Benjamini-Hochberg correction across the twelve tests (Benjamini & Hochberg, 1995), neither result remains significant (adjusted $p = 0.213$ and $p = 0.250$). I find no evidence that grant changes respond to prior changes in shelter finances, staffing, county violence, or child maltreatment.

Table 28: Blocks of Lagged Predictors and the Annual Grant Allocation Equation

	(1) Finance block	(2) Violence block	(3) Demographics block	(4) Combined (levels)	(5) Δ Grant
Lagged grant funding				0.141 (0.258)	
Lagged total revenue	0.249*** (0.070)		0.149 (0.200)		-0.165 (0.115)
Lagged total expenditure	0.366** (0.139)		0.421*** (0.097)		0.048 (0.068)
Lagged compensation	0.267 (0.193)		0.190 (0.204)		0.262 (0.153)
Lagged private donations	-0.165** (0.070)		-0.078 (0.181)		0.112 (0.115)
Lagged program revenue	0.312 (0.261)		-0.382 (0.262)		0.022 (0.174)
Lagged operating margin	omitted		omitted		omitted
Lagged DV homicide rate		2993.8 (8668.9)		-9354.4 (5803.6)	-8483.3 (5598.4)
Lagged county births			-665.7*** (195.2)		-229.4** (101.8)
Lagged county pc income			35.1 (25.6)	17.9* (9.7)	2.9 (2.0)
Lagged county med. HH income			-7.2 (9.3)	1.5 (6.5)	-2.1 (1.7)
Lagged county poverty			-2034.6 (10783.8)	9419.6 (6211.7)	-1062.4 (2761.9)
Lagged county unemployment			-9649.2 (34170.4)	-12765.7 (20535.5)	12911.1 (12843.0)
Joint test (F)	118.71***	0.12	4.59***	152.85***	
Within R^2	0.643	0.000	0.126	0.628	0.151
N	442	423	312	306	306

Notes: Shelter and year fixed effects included in columns (1)–(4); year fixed effects only in column (5), the first-differenced specification. Standard errors clustered by county in parentheses. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

Table 29: Do Prior Changes in Shelter Outcomes Predict the Next Grant Change?

Prior change in:	Coefficient	SE	p	p (Bonferroni)	p (BH)
Total revenue	−0.052	(0.035)	0.142	1.000	0.340
Total expenditure	−0.035	(0.100)	0.725	1.000	0.791
Compensation	0.219	(0.123)	0.083	0.998	0.250
Employee count	722.6	(1,417.0)	0.613	1.000	0.791
Private donations	0.019	(0.051)	0.711	1.000	0.791
IPV hospital discharges	1,483.9	(1,457.2)	0.314	1.000	0.628
DV hospital discharges	49.6	(784.0)	0.950	0.950	0.950
Female assault discharges	−80.3	(45.0)	0.081	0.977	0.250
DV homicide rate	−8,639.6	(4,330.4)	0.052	0.629	0.250
Family violence homicide rate	−3,060.5	(3,695.2)	0.412	1.000	0.706
Female homicide rate	−1,791.4	(726.8)	0.018	0.213	0.213
Substantiated NCANDS reports	−31.4	(55.6)	0.576	1.000	0.791

Notes: Dependent variable is the annual grant change, ΔG_{it} . Each row is a separate regression of the grant change on the prior-year change in the listed outcome, with shelter and year fixed effects and standard errors clustered by county. p (Bonferroni) and p (BH) report Bonferroni-corrected (Dunn, 1961) and Benjamini-Hochberg-adjusted (Benjamini & Hochberg, 1995) p -values across the twelve tests.

C.4 Baseline Funding and Pre-Trends

I test two additional measures of whether a shelter’s pre-2015 funding position predicts its subsequent funding growth: baseline funding level and the pre-2016 funding trend. If either predicts post-expansion growth, shelters would differ systematically in their funding trajectories before the 2015 expansion took effect, complicating a causal interpretation of the Section 6 estimates.

I regress several measures of post-expansion grant growth on 2013 baseline funding (Table 30). The coefficient on baseline funding is positive in each specification, ranging from 0.076 to 0.718, but none is statistically distinguishable from zero. I also use each shelter’s linear pre-2016 grant trend, recovered from $G_{it} = a_i + b_i t + u_{it}$ estimated over 2013–2015, as a predictor of post-expansion growth (Table 31); this coefficient is also positive ($\hat{\theta} = 0.551$) and not statistically distinguishable from zero ($p = 0.187$). Neither baseline funding level nor pre-2016 trend predicts post-expansion growth. Both tests are estimated on 42–45 cross-sectional observations and have limited power to detect a relationship even if one is present;

I read these results as inconclusive rather than as evidence against a relationship between baseline funding conditions and subsequent growth.

Table 30: Post-Expansion Grant Growth on Baseline (2013) Funding

	(1) Initial (16–15)	(2) Avg. post-pre	(3) Avg. post – 3yr avg. pre	(4) Cum. growth
Grant, 2013	0.0759 (0.0889)	0.188 (0.182)		0.718 (0.728)
Grant, 2013–15 avg.			0.316 (0.222)	
Constant	41802.7 (39971.0)	165046.7 (90284.5)	99188.1 (105697.3)	703075.1* (367972.3)
N	42	44	45	42

Robust standard errors in parentheses. *p<0.10, **p<0.05, ***p<0.01.

Table 31: Pre-2016 Grant Trend and Post-Expansion Funding Growth

	$\Delta G_i^{post-pre}$
Pre-2016 grant trend, $\hat{b}_i$	0.551 (0.411)
Constant	268806.4*** (39402.7)
N	45

Robust standard errors in parentheses. *p<0.10, **p<0.05, ***p<0.01.

D Estimator Choice

This appendix discusses why the empirical strategy uses two-way fixed effects (TWFE) with a lagged control rather than estimators developed specifically for continuous or staggered treatment designs.

The forbidden-comparisons problem identified by Callaway and Sant’Anna (2021) and related work arises because already-treated units serve as implicit controls for later-treated units under staggered binary treatment designs, generating negatively weighted comparisons

when treatment effects are heterogeneous over time or across treatment cohorts. This problem motivates a growing literature on estimators for continuous or staggered treatments, including Callaway et al. (2024) and de Chaisemartin et al. (2024).

These estimators are not well suited to this setting. Callaway et al. (2024) requires never-treated or not-yet-treated units to serve as a comparison group; no such units exist here, since every shelter receives government funding every year. de Chaisemartin et al. (2024) accommodates continuous treatment but not staggered timing, and relies on a no-carryover assumption that is difficult to justify given that shelter funding is persistent and cumulative rather than a sequence of one-time shocks, as documented in Appendix C.

Given these constraints, I use TWFE with a one-period lag as the baseline specification, and assess the resulting identifying assumptions directly using the evidence presented in Section 5.2.

E Poisson Specification

For the violence outcomes I additionally estimate a Poisson quasi-maximum likelihood (QMLE) specification:

$$\mathbb{E}[Y_{it} \mid \text{Grants}_{it}, P_{it}] = \exp(\beta \cdot (\text{Grants}/\$100\text{k})_{it} + \alpha_i + \gamma_t + \ln P_{it}), \quad (3)$$

where P_{it} is the relevant population, entered as an exposure offset. The coefficient β approximates the percent change in the outcome rate per \$100,000 increase in grants. Poisson QMLE suits these outcomes well: it is consistent under arbitrary distributions of integer-valued data, accommodates the preponderance of zero counts characterizing the homicide outcomes, and imposes a natural log-linear relationship between grants and the outcome rate. Standard errors are clustered at the county level. These specifications correspond to the OLS results in Section 6.

Table 32 reports the Poisson counterpart to Table 10. The lagged coefficient for

female assault discharges is positive and significant at the 1 percent level, consistent with the OLS result. The IPV and DV discharge coefficients are not significant at either lag, matching the OLS results for these two outcomes.

Table 32: Effects of Government Grants on Hospital Discharges: Poisson

	(1)	(2)	(3)
	IPV Discharge	DV Discharge	Assault Discharge
	Count, pop.	Count, pop.	Count, pop.
	offset	offset	offset
Grants (\$100k)	0.003	0.012	-0.006
	(0.021)	(0.015)	(0.006)
Grants (lagged)	-0.016	-0.006	0.018***
	(0.021)	(0.016)	(0.006)
Observations	264	264	264

Notes: Poisson counterpart to Table 10. Each column regresses the underlying discharge count on grants, with population entered as an exposure offset via `ppmlhdfc`; the resulting coefficient approximates the percent change in the discharge rate per \$100,000 increase in grants. Column definitions match Table 10. Standard errors clustered at the county level in parentheses. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

Table 33 reports the Poisson counterpart to Table 11. The contemporaneous and lagged IPV homicide coefficients are both significant, with the same opposing signs found in the OLS specification: negative same-year, positive the following year. This agreement between OLS and Poisson does not resolve the interpretive difficulty raised in the main text—the sign reversal remains difficult to attribute to a single underlying mechanism regardless of estimator. The remaining homicide measures—DV, female, and child homicides—are not significant at either lag, consistent with the OLS results.

Table 33: Effects of Government Grants on DV Homicides: Poisson

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
	IPV Homicide	DV Homicide	Female Homicide	Child Homicide
Grants (\$100k)	-0.093*** (0.033)	-0.015 (0.049)	-0.051 (0.056)	-0.022 (0.035)
Grants (lagged)	0.121** (0.050)	0.025 (0.051)	-0.033 (0.059)	-0.011 (0.043)
Observations	180	186	152	139

Notes: Poisson counterpart to Table 11. Each column regresses the underlying homicide count on grants, with population entered as an exposure offset via `ppmlhdfe`; the resulting coefficient approximates the percent change in the homicide rate per \$100,000 increase in grants. Sample sizes differ from Table 11 because `ppmlhdfe` drops counties with no within-group outcome variation. Column definitions match Table 11. Standard errors clustered at the county level in parentheses. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

Table 34 reports the Poisson counterpart to Table 12. The coefficient is not significant for any of the seven outcomes at either lag, including substantiated reports for children ages 11–18, for which the OLS specification produced a marginally significant contemporaneous coefficient that did not survive correction for multiple testing. The absence of even marginal significance in the Poisson specification supports treating that OLS result as noise rather than a genuine effect.

Table 34: Effects of Government Grants on Child Maltreatment Reports: Poisson

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)
	All Ages	Infant	Ages 1–3	Ages 4–10	Ages 11–18	DV Risk	Foster
	Substantiated Reports					Factor	Services
Grants (\$100k)	-0.005	-0.002	-0.004	-0.002	-0.010	0.007	0.002
	(0.009)	(0.010)	(0.012)	(0.012)	(0.008)	(0.008)	(0.008)
Grants (lagged)	0.003	0.003	-0.003	-0.002	-0.008	0.011	0.002
	(0.015)	(0.010)	(0.016)	(0.016)	(0.015)	(0.011)	(0.011)
Observations	228	224	224	224	224	224	224

Notes: Poisson counterpart to Table 12. Each column regresses the underlying report count on grants, with population under 18 entered as an exposure offset via `ppmlhdfe`; the resulting coefficient approximates the percent change in the report rate per \$100,000 increase in grants. Sample sizes differ from Table 12 because `ppmlhdfe` drops counties with no within-group outcome variation. Column definitions match Table 12. Standard errors clustered at the county level in parentheses. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

F Full Pairwise Tests: Heterogeneity by Shelter Size

This appendix reports pairwise z -tests comparing the combined two-year effect ($\beta_1 + \beta_2$) across shelter size terciles for every outcome examined in Section 6.4. Because the three tercile regressions are estimated on non-overlapping shelters, the sums being compared are statistically independent, and the test is

$$z = \frac{\text{Sum}_A - \text{Sum}_B}{\sqrt{\text{SE}(\text{Sum}_A)^2 + \text{SE}(\text{Sum}_B)^2}}.$$

Point estimates, standard errors, and same-year and lagged coefficients underlying these tests are reported in Tables 14–19 in the main text. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

Table 35: Pairwise Tests: Revenue

Outcome	Small v. Medium	Small v. Large	Medium v. Large
Total Revenue	-2.45 (0.014**)	-1.75 (0.080*)	0.87 (0.384)
Private Donations	-2.26 (0.024**)	-1.44 (0.151)	0.55 (0.583)
Program Revenue	0.21 (0.834)	-0.54 (0.592)	-0.55 (0.582)
Other Revenue	-2.37 (0.018**)	-1.59 (0.111)	1.62 (0.105)
Grant Share	2.50 (0.012**)	2.20 (0.028**)	-0.77 (0.442)
Private Donation Share	-0.72 (0.470)	-0.66 (0.512)	0.26 (0.798)
Program Revenue Share	0.00 (1.000)	0.89 (0.371)	0.49 (0.628)
Other Revenue Share	-2.51 (0.012**)	-2.30 (0.021**)	0.71 (0.480)

Notes: Each cell reports the z -statistic and, in parentheses, the two-sided p -value for the difference in the combined two-year effect between the two indicated tercile groups. Underlying point estimates and standard errors are reported in Table 14.

Table 36: Pairwise Tests: Expenditure

Outcome	Small v. Medium	Small v. Large	Medium v. Large
Total Expenditure	-2.42 (0.015**)	-1.02 (0.307)	2.42 (0.016**)
Primary Program	-3.08 (0.002***)	-0.83 (0.407)	2.09 (0.036**)
Compensation	-1.83 (0.068*)	-0.41 (0.681)	2.64 (0.008***)
Contract Work	1.54 (0.125)	-1.82 (0.069*)	-2.10 (0.035**)
Operations	-3.18 (0.001***)	0.08 (0.935)	2.34 (0.019**)
Occupancy	-1.04 (0.297)	1.11 (0.268)	1.72 (0.085*)
Fundraising	0.35 (0.723)	-1.36 (0.174)	-1.41 (0.158)
Other Expenditure	-1.77 (0.076*)	-0.28 (0.780)	1.09 (0.276)

Notes: Each cell reports the z -statistic and, in parentheses, the two-sided p -value for the difference in the combined two-year effect between the two indicated tercile groups. Underlying point estimates and standard errors are reported in Table 15.

Table 37: Pairwise Tests: Staffing

Outcome	Small v. Medium	Small v. Large	Medium v. Large
Employee Count	-2.63 (0.008***)	0.06 (0.955)	2.73 (0.006***)
Volunteer Count	0.19 (0.849)	1.82 (0.068*)	0.90 (0.368)
Comp. per Employee	-0.53 (0.599)	-0.27 (0.784)	0.55 (0.579)

Notes: Each cell reports the z -statistic and, in parentheses, the two-sided p -value for the difference in the combined two-year effect between the two indicated tercile groups. Underlying point estimates and standard errors are reported in Table 16. Compensation and Contract Work are omitted here as they duplicate the corresponding rows in Table 36.

Table 38: Pairwise Tests: Hospital Discharges

Outcome	Small v. Medium	Small v. Large	Medium v. Large
IPV Discharge	−0.01 (0.992)	−0.65 (0.518)	−0.78 (0.436)
DV Discharge	−0.04 (0.967)	−0.26 (0.793)	−0.12 (0.905)
Assault Discharge	−0.69 (0.492)	1.42 (0.155)	2.05 (0.041**)

Notes: Each cell reports the z -statistic and, in parentheses, the two-sided p -value for the difference in the combined two-year effect between the two indicated tercile groups. Underlying point estimates and standard errors are reported in Table 17.

Table 39: Pairwise Tests: Homicides

Outcome	Small v. Medium	Small v. Large	Medium v. Large
IPV Homicide	1.58 (0.115)	1.56 (0.118)	−0.35 (0.726)
DV Homicide	1.41 (0.160)	1.50 (0.135)	−0.12 (0.905)
Female Homicide	−1.89 (0.059*)	−2.20 (0.028**)	−1.29 (0.196)
Child Homicide	−0.52 (0.601)	0.03 (0.975)	0.57 (0.567)

Notes: Each cell reports the z -statistic and, in parentheses, the two-sided p -value for the difference in the combined two-year effect between the two indicated tercile groups. Underlying point estimates and standard errors are reported in Table 18.

Table 40: Pairwise Tests: Child Maltreatment Reports (NCANDS)

Outcome	Small v. Medium	Small v. Large	Medium v. Large
All Ages	0.84 (0.402)	0.39 (0.698)	−1.10 (0.273)
Infant	−0.52 (0.603)	−0.38 (0.705)	0.47 (0.637)
Ages 1–3	1.31 (0.192)	0.89 (0.373)	−1.00 (0.318)
Ages 4–10	0.87 (0.383)	0.40 (0.690)	−1.04 (0.299)
Ages 11–18	1.25 (0.210)	0.52 (0.604)	−1.70 (0.089*)
DV Risk Factor	0.63 (0.531)	0.32 (0.752)	−0.92 (0.359)
Foster Services	0.80 (0.423)	1.05 (0.296)	0.04 (0.969)

Notes: Each cell reports the z -statistic and, in parentheses, the two-sided p -value for the difference in the combined two-year effect between the two indicated tercile groups. Underlying point estimates and standard errors are reported in Table 19.

G Additional Robustness

This appendix reports the full breakdown of four checks summarized in the main-text robustness section (Section 7): a December fiscal-year subsample, a pre-2020 subsample, a specification with time-varying county controls, and an Oster bounding exercise. Each check addresses a distinct threat to the parallel trends assumption in Section 5.2: measurement error from fiscal-year misalignment, confounding from COVID-era disruption, confounding from time-varying county economic conditions, and sensitivity to selection on unobservables not captured by shelter and year fixed effects. Every check reports β_1 , β_2 , and their combined two-year sum, with the sum’s standard error computed via a Wald test, matching the convention used throughout the paper.

G.1 December Fiscal Year Shelters

This check addresses whether the rule assigning Form 990 filings to federal award years introduces measurement error for shelters whose fiscal year does not end in December. Because grants are awarded on October 1st (Section 3), a shelter’s own fiscal year-end determines how closely its 990 filing aligns with the federal award year. Restricting to the 24 shelters with December fiscal year ends, the largest single group in the panel, removes this alignment ambiguity entirely.

Table 41 reports the full outcome set. The combined two-year effects on total revenue, total expenditure, compensation, and employee count remain significant in the December FY subsample and are similar in magnitude to the full-sample estimates (\$95,800 versus \$99,700 for revenue; \$84,800 versus \$82,500 for expenditure; \$45,100 versus \$43,100 for compensation; 1.194 versus 0.913 for employee count). The combined effect on private donations remains statistically indistinguishable from zero in both samples. This agreement indicates that fiscal-year misalignment is not driving the paper’s central financial and staffing results.

Table 41: Robustness: December Fiscal Year Shelters, Full Results

Outcome		Main	Dec FY	Outcome		Main	Dec FY
Total Revenue	β_1	0.619***	0.867***	Primary Program	β_1	0.447***	0.603***
	β_2	0.378**	0.090		β_2	0.266***	0.224***
	Sum	0.997***	0.958***		Sum	0.713***	0.827***
	Mean	12.888	11.357		Mean	9.081	8.242
Private Donations	β_1	-0.389**	-0.086	Compensation	β_1	0.316***	0.355***
	β_2	0.397**	0.042		β_2	0.116***	0.096
	Sum	0.008	-0.043		Sum	0.431***	0.451***
	Mean	3.046	2.692		Mean	7.008	6.060
Program Revenue	β_1	0.021	-0.007	Contract Work	β_1	0.047*	-0.016
	β_2	0.008	0.004		β_2	0.020	0.095
	Sum	0.030	-0.003		Sum	0.068*	0.079
	Mean	0.273	0.209		Mean	0.513	0.493
Other Revenue	β_1	-0.013	-0.040	Operations	β_1	0.034	0.069*
	β_2	-0.028	0.044		β_2	-0.001	-0.031
	Sum	-0.041	0.004		Sum	0.033*	0.038
	Mean	0.857	0.752		Mean	0.469	0.323
Grant Share	β_1	0.031***	0.023***	Occupancy	β_1	-0.009	0.017*
	β_2	-0.010***	-0.004		β_2	0.040*	0.004
	Sum	0.021***	0.019**		Sum	0.031***	0.022
	Mean	0.680	0.666		Mean	0.661	0.621
Private Donation Share	β_1	-0.027***	-0.013**	Fundraising	β_1	0.051	0.083
	β_2	0.014***	0.005		β_2	0.013	0.035
	Sum	-0.014**	-0.008		Sum	0.064	0.118
	Mean	0.226	0.247		Mean	0.519	0.461
Program Revenue Share	β_1	-0.000	-0.001	Other Expenditure	β_1	0.135**	0.128
	β_2	0.001	-0.000		β_2	0.064	0.012
	Sum	0.001	-0.001		Sum	0.199**	0.139
	Mean	0.022	0.018		Mean	2.820	2.542
Other Revenue Share	β_1	-0.003	-0.009**	Employee Count	β_1	0.411*	0.621**
	β_2	-0.004	-0.002		β_2	0.503**	0.574***
	Sum	-0.008*	-0.010		Sum	0.913***	1.194***
	Mean	0.072	0.069		Mean	27.240	25.331
Total Expenditure	β_1	0.573***	0.636***	Volunteer Count	β_1	-1.319	-0.986
	β_2	0.252***	0.212***		β_2	-2.129*	4.072
	Sum	0.825***	0.848***		Sum	-3.448	3.087
	Mean	11.989	10.500		Mean	53.980	56.690

Notes: The table reports β_1 (same-year), β_2 (lagged), and Sum (combined two-year effect, with Wald-test standard error) for the full sample (“Main”) and the 24 shelters with December fiscal year ends (“Dec FY”); one additional December-FY shelter is excluded from the analysis panel entirely, as described in Section 3. The Mean row reports each outcome’s sample mean for the respective column’s sample. Revenue and expenditure outcomes are in \$100k units. All regressions include shelter and year fixed effects with standard errors clustered at the shelter level. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

G.2 Pre-2020 Sample

This check addresses whether the paper’s results are an artifact of COVID-era disruption to shelter operations or grant funding patterns, rather than a general feature of the funding relationship. Restricting the financial sample to fiscal years 2013–2019 aligns it with the violence outcome data, which already ends in 2019 for the same reason (Section 3).

Table 42 reports the full outcome set. The combined two-year effect on total revenue rises from \$99,700 in the main specification to \$86,400 pre-2020, and total expenditure rises from \$82,500 to \$92,800. Compensation and employee count also remain significant, with combined effects somewhat larger pre-2020 (\$59,300 and 0.910, versus \$43,100 and 0.913). The combined effect on private donations is a significant decline in the pre-2020 subsample (\$18,900), in contrast to the statistically indistinguishable-from-zero full-sample combined effect (\$800). This larger pre-2020 decline traces to a more negative same-year coefficient (\$50,100 versus \$38,900). The lagged coefficient, meanwhile, shrinks and loses individual significance. The grant share and private donation share combined effects are also somewhat larger pre-2020. The combined effect on volunteer count remains statistically indistinguishable from zero in both samples. These results indicate that the paper’s central findings are not artifacts of COVID-era disruption. If anything, several combined estimates are larger in the pre-2020 period, and the private donations result is directionally consistent but more pronounced.

Table 42: Robustness: Pre-2020 Sample, Full Results

Outcome		Main	Pre-2020	Outcome		Main	Pre-2020
Total Revenue	β_1	0.619***	0.500**	Primary Program	β_1	0.447***	0.540***
	β_2	0.378**	0.364**		β_2	0.266***	0.170**
	Sum	0.997***	0.864***		Sum	0.713***	0.710***
	Mean	12.888	11.012		Mean	9.081	7.893
Private Donations	β_1	-0.389**	-0.501**	Compensation	β_1	0.316***	0.389***
	β_2	0.397**	0.312		β_2	0.116***	0.204**
	Sum	0.008	-0.189		Sum	0.431***	0.593***
	Mean	3.046	2.495		Mean	7.008	6.197
Program Revenue	β_1	0.021	0.013	Contract Work	β_1	0.047*	0.030**
	β_2	0.008	-0.010		β_2	0.020	-0.025**
	Sum	0.030	0.003		Sum	0.068*	0.005
	Mean	0.273	0.248		Mean	0.513	0.484
Other Revenue	β_1	-0.013	-0.012	Operations	β_1	0.034	0.059***
	β_2	-0.028	0.062		β_2	-0.001	-0.011
	Sum	-0.041	0.049		Sum	0.033*	0.048**
	Mean	0.857	0.821		Mean	0.469	0.398
Grant Share	β_1	0.031***	0.034***	Occupancy	β_1	-0.009	0.007
	β_2	-0.010***	-0.016***		β_2	0.040*	0.024***
	Sum	0.021***	0.019***		Sum	0.031***	0.030*
	Mean	0.680	0.683		Mean	0.661	0.586
Private Donation Share	β_1	-0.027***	-0.031***	Fundraising	β_1	0.051	0.030**
	β_2	0.014***	0.012**		β_2	0.013	0.017
	Sum	-0.014**	-0.020***		Sum	0.064	0.047*
	Mean	0.226	0.223		Mean	0.519	0.432
Program Revenue Share	β_1	-0.000	-0.000	Other Expenditure	β_1	0.135**	0.147***
	β_2	0.001	0.000		β_2	0.064	0.057
	Sum	0.001	0.000		Sum	0.199**	0.204***
	Mean	0.022	0.024		Mean	2.820	2.407
Other Revenue Share	β_1	-0.003	-0.003	Employee Count	β_1	0.411*	0.569**
	β_2	-0.004	0.004		β_2	0.503**	0.341
	Sum	-0.008*	0.000		Sum	0.913***	0.910***
	Mean	0.072	0.071		Mean	27.240	27.214
Total Expenditure	β_1	0.573***	0.661***	Volunteer Count	β_1	-1.319	-0.930
	β_2	0.252***	0.266**		β_2	-2.129*	0.309
	Sum	0.825***	0.928***		Sum	-3.448	-0.620
	Mean	11.989	10.504		Mean	53.980	76.956

Notes: The table reports β_1 (same-year), β_2 (lagged), and Sum (combined two-year effect, with Wald-test standard error) for the full sample (“Main”) and the fiscal-year-2013–2019 subsample (“Pre-2020”). The Mean row reports each outcome’s sample mean for the respective column’s sample. Revenue and expenditure outcomes are in \$100k units. All regressions include shelter and year fixed effects with standard errors clustered at the shelter level. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

G.3 Sensitivity to Time-Varying County Controls

This check addresses whether within-shelter changes in grant funding are correlated with time-varying county economic conditions that also affect outcomes. Section 5.2 presents the primary evidence on this concern (balancing regressions, an event study, and a direct examination of the grant allocation process). The check reported here is complementary, adding three time-varying county-level controls, median household income, poverty rate, and unemployment rate, directly to the main specification.

Table 43 reports the full outcome set. Both specifications are estimated on the same 2013–2023 sample, so the comparison is unaffected by any difference in sample composition. Combined two-year effects are stable across nearly every outcome, with only modest changes in magnitude in either direction (revenue moves from \$99,700 to \$98,900; expenditure from \$82,500 to \$82,000). One result changes meaningfully. The combined effect on volunteer count, not significant in the main specification, becomes marginally significant with controls added ($-3,951$, driven by a significant same-year coefficient). Given that this is the only outcome whose significance status changes, I do not read this as evidence that the main specification is misspecified. The overall stability of the combined revenue, expenditure, and staffing effects is consistent with the identifying variation coming primarily from within-shelter changes in grant funding rather than county-level economic conditions, though income, poverty, and unemployment are a limited set of controls and do not rule out confounding from characteristics they do not capture.

Table 43: Robustness: Including Time-Varying County Controls, Full Results

Outcome		Main	Controls	Outcome		Main	Controls
Total Revenue	β_1	0.619***	0.613***	Primary Program	β_1	0.447***	0.440***
	β_2	0.378**	0.377**		β_2	0.266***	0.266***
	Sum	0.997***	0.989***		Sum	0.713***	0.705***
	Mean	12.888	12.888		Mean	9.081	9.081
Private Donations	β_1	-0.389**	-0.393**	Compensation	β_1	0.316***	0.315***
	β_2	0.397**	0.396**		β_2	0.116***	0.115***
	Sum	0.008	0.002		Sum	0.431***	0.429***
	Mean	3.046	3.046		Mean	7.008	7.008
Program Revenue	β_1	0.021	0.020	Contract Work	β_1	0.047*	0.051*
	β_2	0.008	0.008		β_2	0.020	0.020
	Sum	0.030	0.028		Sum	0.068*	0.071**
	Mean	0.273	0.273		Mean	0.513	0.513
Other Revenue	β_1	-0.013	-0.014	Operations	β_1	0.034	0.035
	β_2	-0.028	-0.027		β_2	-0.001	-0.001
	Sum	-0.041	-0.041		Sum	0.033*	0.034**
	Mean	0.857	0.857		Mean	0.469	0.469
Grant Share	β_1	0.031***	0.031***	Occupancy	β_1	-0.009	-0.009
	β_2	-0.010***	-0.010***		β_2	0.040*	0.040*
	Sum	0.021***	0.022***		Sum	0.031***	0.031***
	Mean	0.680	0.680		Mean	0.661	0.661
Private Donation Share	β_1	-0.027***	-0.028***	Fundraising	β_1	0.051	0.052
	β_2	0.014***	0.014***		β_2	0.013	0.013
	Sum	-0.014**	-0.014**		Sum	0.064	0.065
	Mean	0.226	0.226		Mean	0.519	0.519
Program Revenue Share	β_1	-0.000	-0.000	Other Expenditure	β_1	0.135**	0.126**
	β_2	0.001	0.001		β_2	0.064	0.064
	Sum	0.001	0.001		Sum	0.199**	0.190**
	Mean	0.022	0.022		Mean	2.820	2.820
Other Revenue Share	β_1	-0.003	-0.003	Employee Count	β_1	0.411*	0.390**
	β_2	-0.004	-0.004		β_2	0.503**	0.496***
	Sum	-0.008*	-0.008*		Sum	0.913***	0.886***
	Mean	0.072	0.072		Mean	28.050	28.050
Total Expenditure	β_1	0.573***	0.569***	Volunteer Count	β_1	-1.319	-4.975*
	β_2	0.252***	0.251***		β_2	-2.129*	1.024
	Sum	0.825***	0.820***		Sum	-3.448	-3.951
	Mean	11.989	11.989		Mean	66.274	66.274

Notes: The table reports β_1 (same-year), β_2 (lagged), and Sum (combined two-year effect, with Wald-test standard error) for the main specification (“Main”) and the specification adding time-varying county-level controls (“Controls”): median household income, poverty rate, and unemployment rate. Both specifications are estimated on the same 2013–2023 sample, so the Mean row is identical across columns for every outcome. Revenue and expenditure outcomes are in \$100k units. All regressions include shelter and year fixed effects with standard errors clustered at the shelter level. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

G.4 Oster Bounding

This check addresses selection on unobservables not captured by any of the checks above. Rather than restricting the sample or adding specific controls, it bounds how much unobserved, time-varying confounding would be needed to explain away the estimated effect, following Oster (2019). I apply this method to the combined two-year effect $\beta_1 + \beta_2$, since the sum is the paper’s primary quantity of interest throughout, using the movement in the coefficient and R^2 between an uncontrolled specification (year fixed effects only) and the controlled specification (shelter and year fixed effects). The method produces δ , the ratio of selection on unobservables to selection on observables that would be required to attribute the full effect to omitted variables. A common benchmark treats $|\delta| \geq 1$ as evidence that an effect is not easily explained by omitted confounders.

Table 44 reports δ for five outcomes. Total Revenue, Total Expenditure, Compensation, and Employee Count all clear the benchmark comfortably ($\delta = 2.93, 6.11, 3.15$, and 3.70 , respectively): unobserved selection would need to be several times stronger than the selection already absorbed by shelter fixed effects to account for these combined effects. Grant Share’s δ estimate (-4.38) is sign-reversed, a pattern that arises when the change in R^2 between specifications is large relative to the change in the coefficient, and is uninformative regardless of the estimate’s underlying stability; I instead report the coefficient identified at the conventional $\delta = 1$ benchmark, 0.026 , close to the controlled specification’s own estimate of 0.021 .

Across all five outcomes, I do not find evidence that selection on unobserved shelter characteristics is likely to explain the estimated combined effects. As with any Oster bounding exercise, this is one piece of evidence to be weighed alongside the identification checks in Section 5.2 — particularly the direct examination of the grant allocation process — rather than read as a formal test.

Table 44: Oster Bounding: Selection on Unobservables (Combined Two-Year Effect)

Outcome	Uncontrolled $\hat{\beta}_{sum}$	Controlled $\hat{\beta}_{sum}$	Uncontrolled R^2	Controlled R^2	δ
Total Revenue	1.444	0.997	0.866	0.942	2.93
Total Expenditure	1.361	0.825	0.884	0.977	6.11
Compensation	0.723	0.431	0.837	0.948	3.15
Employee Count	1.618	0.872	0.399	0.856	3.70
Grant Share	0.007	0.021	0.091	0.759	-4.38

Notes: Both specifications control for the contemporaneous and lagged grant coefficients (β_1, β_2); the coefficient reported is their sum, $\hat{\beta}_{sum} = \hat{\beta}_1 + \hat{\beta}_2$. Uncontrolled specification includes year fixed effects only; controlled specification includes shelter and year fixed effects, matching the main specification. δ is the Oster (2019) bounding parameter, with R_{max} set to 1.3 times the controlled R^2 (capped at 1), following convention. Revenue, expenditure, and compensation coefficients are expressed in \$100,000 units. Grant Share's δ is sign-reversed and uninformative; the coefficient identified at the conventional $\delta = 1$ benchmark is 0.026, close to the controlled estimate reported here. Outcomes with an already-insignificant combined effect in the main specification (private donations, program revenue, other revenue, volunteer count) are omitted from this table; Oster bounds are less informative for effects not distinguishable from zero.

G.5 Summary

Across four checks addressing four distinct threats to identification—fiscal-year misalignment, COVID-era disruption, time-varying county confounders, and selection on unobservables—the paper's central financial and staffing results are stable. Combined two-year effects on revenue, expenditure, compensation, and employee count remain significant and similar in magnitude throughout, and the statistically indistinguishable-from-zero combined effect on private donations holds except in the pre-2020 subsample, where it strengthens into a significant decline rather than reversing. No single check overturns or substantially reweights the main specification's conclusions.